



Lesson Outline

Overview

1. Intro
 2. Dynamic Warm Up
 3. SEL Skill Discussion
 4. Skill Drill
 5. Game (*w/ Rules Meeting*)
 - a. Schedule will include multiple skill drills
 - b. Run **at least 1** skill drill, if time allows, run the others but ensure there is at least 20 minutes for the scheduled game.
 6. Warm Down / Reflection / Clean up
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Planning & Prep (30 mins) – Before every lesson

Before the lesson, review the lesson plan for the day and identify the materials, field/blacktop setup, and any weather or space considerations that may affect play. Review the day's SEL word (skill) and determine how it will connect to the game or drill you've doing. Understand the rules of the game and drills and ensure you understand how to explain it to your assigned grade group so they can play it correctly and safely.

Outline

1. Intro (2-5 mins)

- a. What we are doing today
 - i. *We are:*
 1. *Warming up and a quick water/rest break*
 2. *Having a discussion*
 3. *Game (majority of the time)*
- b. What skills we are focusing on (review skills)
- c. Assign students equally into team colors (for dynamic warm up and/or for game)

2. Dynamic Warm Up (10 mins)

3. SEL Discussion (5-10 mins)

- d. What is it (define it for the students)
- e. How we will practice it today.

4. Skill Drill

5. Game (20+ mins)

- f. **Rules Meeting**
 - i. Safety Rules (high Priority)
 - ii. Extra/Fun Rules (low Priority)

- iii. Game Rules (*explain how to play the game*)
 1. *Circle back to High/Low priority rules (as needed)*

- g. Begin Game
- h. Water / Rest Breaks (as needed)

6. Warm Down, Reflection & Clean Up (5-10 minutes)

- i. *What was the name of the SEL skill we practiced today?*
 - i. *How did we practice it?*
 1. *How did you (the student) practice?*
 2. *Can you give an example of others showing the skill?*
- j. *What Sport Skills did we focus on today?*
 - i. *How did we practice them during the skills drill/game?*
- k. Clean up / Transition

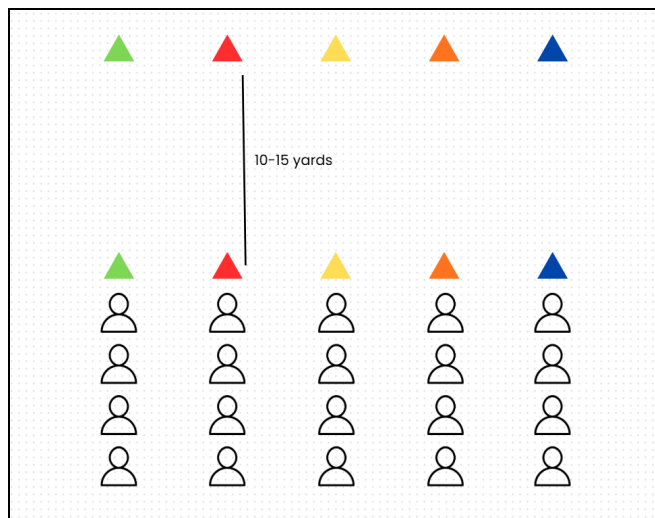


Dynamic Warm Up

Dynamic Warm Up Outline

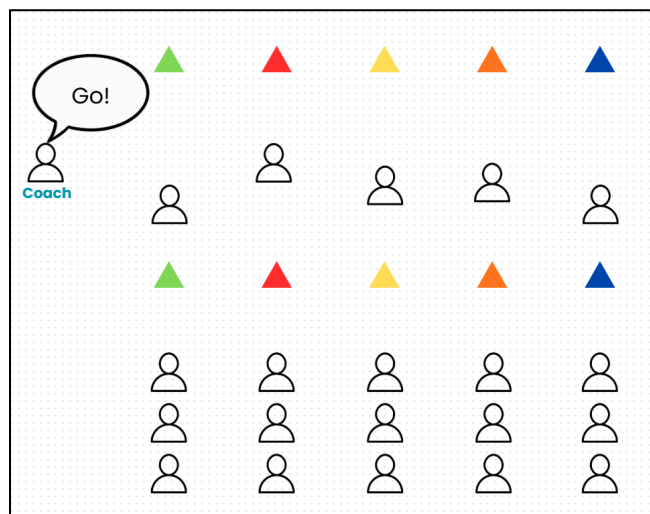
Setup

1. Arrange different colored cones in a straight line to create the **start cones**.
2. Place a matching cone of the same color **10–15 yards away** from each start cone to create the **end cones**.
3. Divide students into **4–6 teams**, depending on the number of students and available cone colors.
4. Assign each student a cone color and have students line up **behind their team's start cone** — **facing the end cone**



How it works

1. Select, explain and demonstrate the movement students will perform (for example: **high knees, skipping, angle taps, karaoke, lunges, etc.**).
2. On the coach's signal ("Go!" or whistle), the **first student in each line** performs the movement from the **start cone to the matching end cone**.
3. Once students reach the end cone, they should **go to the back of their team's line**.
4. Continue the drill with the next student in line.
5. Repeat with **different movements**
6. The entire warm up should last at least **10 minutes** — **Add movements as needed**



Dynamic Warm Up Outline

Assessment:

1. **Observe movement:**
 - a. Are students performing the movement as directed?
 - b. What about the movement is most important for them to perform?
 - i. Ankle Taps → Finger tips touching side of ankle
 - ii. High Knees → Knee bends at least 90 degrees
2. **Monitor effort:** If students show a lack of effort prompt them with:
 - a. "Let's try that again, I need everyone giving their best effort you don't need to be perfect"
3. **Emphasize control over speed:** Ensure students are not rushing and are completing movements with proper form.
4. **Encourage and reward participation:** Meet every student at their level, don't expect perfection with any criteria.
5. **Reminder of Purpose:** Remind students that the goal is to warm up the body in preparation for the skill drill and game.
6. **Promote safety:** Highlight that proper warm-up helps prevent injury.
7. **Check team organization:** Ensure students return to and remain with their original team/color group (e.g., Green to Green, Red to Red).
 - a. Use numbers in each line to ensure.
8. **Make it fun:** Add or adapt movements that make the students engaged
 - a. Arm Circles → Chicken Dance

Movement Examples:

Mix & match these to fit the skill level of your students, the time and equipment available.

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|-------------------|----------------------|
| 1. Marching bands | 11. Lunges |
| 2. Ankle Taps | 12. Reverse Pac-Mans |
| 3. Snowboard hops | 13. Mario jumps |
| 4. Bunny hops | 14. Jogging |
| 5. Side shuffles | 15. Sprints |
| 6. High knees | 16. Penguin Walks |
| 7. High Kicks | 17. Bear Crawls |
| 8. Arm Circles | 18. Frog Jumps |
| 9. Ankle Scoops | 19. Walking Twists |
| 10. Karaoke's | 20. Pogo-Hops |

SEL Components

SEL Components

Overview:

- How to Structure the Discussion
 - Facilitation
 - Topic/Skill Tables
 - *Self-Management*
 - *Social Awareness*
 - *Relationship Skills*
 - *Responsible Decision Making*
 - *Self Awareness*
-

How to Structure the Discussion (Every Session)

- **Step 1 — Name It** — State the SEL skill clearly. Give a **short, student-friendly definition** in your own words.
 - **Step 2 — Connect It** — Link the skill to what students are about to do. Use the sports context prompt for your skill. **Ask:** *"Where might you see this today?"*
 - **Step 3 — Discuss It** — Ask the discussion prompt and let students respond. Aim for 2–4 student voices. Validate what they say, then **build on it**.
 - **Step 4 — Transfer It** — Before ending, ask a transfer prompt. Help students name where else this skill shows up; **in class, at home, with friends**.
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Facilitation

- **Getting Students to Talk**
 - Use think time.
 - Say "Take 5-10 seconds to think" before asking for hands. Silence is okay."
 - **Use turn-and-talk.** Pair students before sharing out
 - **Use sentence starters.**
 - *"A time I showed this skill was..."*
 - *"This connects to..."*
 - *"One place I could use this is..."*
 - After a student responds, say "Yes, and..." or "That's a great example of..."
- **Keep it focused**

SEL Components

- Target 2–4 voices. Quality over quantity. Redirect gently if a student goes off topic.
- **Use call-back moments throughout the lesson and during the Reflection**
 - “Remember when we did ... that was an example of...”
 - “How did you practice this skill today?”

Self-Management Skills	
Skill	Prompt
Emotional Regulation	<i>Managing frustration after missing a shot or losing possession of the ball.</i>
Perseverance	<i>Continuing to try after mistakes or unsuccessful attempts.</i>
Focus & Attention	<i>Staying attentive to instructions, plays, and teammates during games.</i>
Effort & Work Ethic	<i>Hustling on defense, chasing loose balls, or continuing to practice skills.</i>
Impulse Control	<i>Pausing before reacting to a bad call, a physical foul, or a taunting opponent</i>

Social Awareness Skills	
Skill	Prompt
Respect for Others	<i>Respecting teammates, opponents, referees, and rules.</i>
Empathy	<i>Encouraging teammates who are struggling or feeling disappointed.</i>
Sportsmanship	<i>Winning and losing gracefully and showing respect after games.</i>
Inclusivity	<i>Passing the ball and involving teammates of different skill levels.</i>

SEL Components

Perspective Taking	<i>Recognizing that a teammate or opponent may be playing through personal challenges, fatigue, or frustration and adjusting how you respond to them</i>
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Relationship Skills	
Skill	Prompt
Teamwork	<i>Collaborating to move the ball and score.</i>
Communication	<i>Calling for the ball, signaling defensive help, or organizing teammates.</i>
Conflict Resolution	<i>Resolving disagreements about fouls, rules, or gameplay fairly.</i>
Leadership	<i>Helping organize teammates and modeling positive behavior.</i>
Trust-Building	<i>Relying on a teammate to be in the right position, follow through on their role, and show up consistently</i>

Responsible Decision-Making	
Skill	Prompt
Strategic Thinking	Deciding when to pass, shoot, or dribble.
Fair Play	Following rules and playing honestly.
Safety Awareness	Playing in control to avoid collisions or unsafe actions.
Accountability	Taking responsibility for mistakes or fouls.
Adaptability	Adjusting your strategy when a play isn't working or the defense changes.

Self-Awareness	
Skill	Prompt
Confidence	Believing in one's ability to contribute to the team.

SEL Components

Growth Mindset	Recognizing that skills improve with practice.
Self-Reflection	Thinking about what went well and what could improve after games.
Emotional Awareness	Recognizing feelings like frustration or excitement during play.
Self-Awareness	Understanding your strengths and limitations to make smart decisions during a game.

Curriculum

Sports Curriculum — ELP Summer 2026

This section contains the full physical education and sports curriculum for the Expanded Learning Program (ELP) Summer 2026. It is organized across three sport/activity categories, each broken into their own sub-tabs with detailed activity guides for staff.

All activities include **setup instructions**, **game rules**, **coaching cues**, **grade-band modifications**, and **focus areas**. Reference video links are included where applicable.

Soccer Structured drills and games built around core soccer skills. Drills cover dribbling (dominant foot, lateral, and two-footed control), passing (ground passes, moving passes, and small-sided passing), and shooting (shots on goal, penalty kicks, and combination finishing). Games reinforce these skills in competitive formats including 1v1 defending, multi-team scoring, and accuracy challenges like Soccer Golf and Tic-Tac-Toe.

Basketball Skill-based drills and active games focused on fundamental basketball development. Drills cover dribbling (stationary, lateral, and directional), passing (bounce and lob passes in stationary and moving formats), and layups (approach, form, and defended finishing). Games range from dribbling challenges like Knockout and Freeze Tag to shooting competitions like Lightning and Around the Arc.

Other Games A collection of supplemental activities organized by setting — field, blacktop, and indoor — providing coaches with flexible options across any environment. Field games include large-group team games like Kickball, Capture the Flag, and Zone Pass Challenge. Blacktop games feature wall and court-based activities like Handball, Foursquare, and Clean Your Yard. Indoor games offer low-equipment options like Silent Ball, Cup Stack, and Four Corners, suitable for classroom or gym use.



ELP Summer 2026

Sports Curriculum - Basketball

This section contains the full basketball curriculum for the Expanded Learning Program (ELP) Summer 2026. It is organized across two sub-tabs: one focused on **skill-based drills** and one focused on **basketball games**. All activities include setup instructions, rules, coaching cues, age-appropriate modifications, and reference video links where applicable.

Basketball Skill Drills Structured drills targeting individual and partner skill development. Activities are broken into three categories:

- **Dribbling** – Dribble Intro, Shuffle Dribble, 1-2-3 Switch Dribble, Zig-Zag Dribble
- **Shooting & Layups** – 4-Line Layups, 2-Line Free Throw, 1-2 Layup Drill, Octopus Layup
- **Passing** – Rainbow Passing (Lob Pass), Bounce Passing, Side-by-Side Passing, Player in the Middle

These drills include grade-band modifications (TK–2nd, 3rd-4th, & 5th-6th) to support instruction.

Basketball Games Active games designed to reinforce dribbling, shooting, and teamwork in a fun, competitive format. Games include:

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ● Dribble Knockout | ● Sink the Ship |
| ● Hot Shots | ● Around the Arc |
| ● Kingpin | ● Dribble Freeze Tag |
| ● Dribble Tag | ● Color Cone Dribble |
| ● Lightning | ● Sharks & Minnows Dribble |
| ● Team Eleven | ● 3-Point Around the World |
| ● Dribbling Obstacle Course | ● Passing Keepaway |
| ● Dribble Relay | ● 21 |

Some drills and games include a reference video link for coach preview.

More games/drills may be added

Skill Drills - Basketball

Skill Drills - Basketball

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Skill Drill: Dribble Intro

 **Reference Video:** Dribble Intro — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SS96BIIBjJ4>

Skill Focus
Ball control Consistent dribble height Eyes up

1 — Setup & Materials

- Use a basketball court or open blacktop with clear sidelines.
- Give each student a basketball (or share if limited supply).
- Have students line up along one sideline, each with space to move.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students dribble the ball using one hand from one sideline to the other.
- Players face forward and keep their head up the entire time.
- Students stop at the opposite sideline or return back — coach's choice.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student keeping their eyes up, or are they staring at the ball?
- Is the dribble at a consistent height (roughly waist level)?
- Are students using their fingertips, not their palms?
- Is the student maintaining control without the ball getting away from them?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to use both hands or self-toss and catch instead of a full dribble.
 - Use lighter balls (handballs or small foam balls) if a standard basketball is too heavy.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require students to use both their dominant and non-dominant hand.
 - Add a simple instruction mid-activity: switch hands on the coach's signal.
- **5th–6th:**

- Challenge students to alternate hands every 3 dribbles.
- Increase pace — students dribble at a jog or run while maintaining control.

Phrases to Use

- "Eyes up — find a spot, keep your eyes on it the whole way!"
 - "Fingertips, not your palm — dribble like the ball is hot!"
 - "Stay in control. Slow down if you need to — speed comes later."
 - "Nice! You barely looked at the ball that time."
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Skill Drill: Shuffle Dribble

Skill Focus	Coordination Lateral movement Ball control
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1 — Setup

- Use a basketball court or open blacktop with clear sidelines.
- Give each student a basketball (or share if limited supply)..
- Students line up along one sideline facing the same direction (parallel to the line).

2 — What They'll Do

- Students shuffle sideways from one sideline to the other while dribbling with one hand.
- Players must keep feet from crossing — true lateral shuffle movement.
- Students remain facing the same direction throughout.
- At the coach's signal or halfway point, students may switch direction or dribbling hand.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Are students shuffling (not crossing their feet) or reverting to a run?
- Is the dribble staying close to their side as they move laterally?
- Are students staying low and in an athletic stance?
- Is the student's head up or looking at the ball and the floor?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to walk the shuffle instead of moving quickly.
 - Let students use both hands or carry the ball if dribbling while shuffling is too difficult.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require students to maintain a consistent dribble on one side.
 - Add a direction change at the halfway cone or on the coach's signal.
- **5th–6th:**

- Add a hand switch at the midpoint — dribble with right hand going one way, left hand on the return.
- Increase the width of the course to push lateral range.

Phrases to Use

- "Don't cross your feet — stay in your shuffle!"
 - "Stay low — bend your knees like you're playing defense."
 - "Keep the ball on the side you're moving toward."
 - "Good rhythm — stay consistent with your dribble!"
-

Skill Drill: 1-2-3 Switch Dribble

Skill Focus

Hand switching | Rhythm | Ball control

1 — Setup

- Use a basketball court or open blacktop with clear sidelines.
- Give each student a basketball (or share if limited supply)..
- Students line up along one sideline with space to move forward.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students dribble from one sideline to the other.
- They dribble 3 times with one hand, then switch hands and dribble 3 times with the other.
- The pattern repeats across the full width of the court.
- Students may stop at the opposite sideline or return — coach's choice.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Are students completing exactly 3 dribbles before switching, or losing count?
- Is the hand switch smooth, or does the student pause and reset?
- Is the student maintaining consistent dribble height through the switch?
- Are students keeping their head up, or looking down at the transition?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Reduce to 1-2 dribbles per hand if 3 is too complex.
 - Have students count aloud to help with rhythm and hand switching.
 - Have students stop moving, self-transfer the ball to the other hand, then continue
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Hold students to exactly 3 dribbles — count out loud to keep rhythm.
 - Encourage them to keep moving without pausing at the switch.

- **5th–6th:**
 - Increase to 5 dribbles per hand and have them call it out.
 - Add a speed element — challenge them to get across faster while maintaining the pattern.

Phrases to Use

- "Count out loud — 1, 2, 3 — switch!"
 - "Don't stop moving when you switch hands. Keep going!"
 - "Control through the switch. That's the hard part."
 - "Nice switch — did you even look down? That's the goal!"
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Skill Drill: 4-Line Layups

Skill Focus	Layup form Approach angles Finishing repetition
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1 — Setup

- Set up 4 lines around the key, starting near the 3-point line (one line at each angle: left corner, left elbow, right elbow, right corner).
- Place a ball at the front of each line.
- If a rebounder is available, position them near the basket to return balls.

2 — What They'll Do

- One player at a time steps out from the front of their line.
- The student walks or jogs toward the basket and attempts a layup using the backboard.
- If they miss, they get 2 additional attempts before rotating.
- After their turn, the player rotates to the back of the next line.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student using the backboard, or attempting straight-on shots?
- Are they using the correct foot for the step-through (right hand = left foot plant)?
- Is the approach controlled — not rushing — with a proper two-step layup finish?
- Is the student aiming for the square on the backboard?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to walk the entire approach — no running required.
 - Start all lines from closer in (under the key) so the target is easier to reach.
 - Allow students to use any hand without enforcing the step-through footwork.
 - Utilize portable hoops.
- **3rd–4th:**

- Encourage proper footwork — coach should walk through it once before the drill begins. Pause and show again as needed.
- Allow a slow jog approach.
- Reinforce using the backboard: 'Use the square!'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require proper footwork (right-hand layup = left foot last step).
 - Increase approach speed — full jog.
 - Add a challenge: make it from all 4 lines before rotating.

Phrases to Use

- "Use the square on the backboard — aim there, not the rim."
 - "Last two steps: big step, small step, up!"
 - "Keep it soft — kiss it off the glass."
 - "Eyes on the box, not the defender."
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Skill Drill: 2-Line Free Throw

Skill Focus

Shooting under pressure | Rebounding | Transitions

1 — Setup

- Create 2 lines starting at the top of the key — one team per line.
- One player from each line steps to the free throw line at a time.
- The two teams alternate turns or go simultaneously depending on space.

2 — What They'll Do

- One player from each line steps to the center of the free throw line.
- The student takes 1 shot.
- If they miss, they may chase their own rebound and attempt 1 follow-up layup.
- After their turn, the player goes to the back of the opposite line.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student using proper free throw form — bent knees, elbow in, follow through?
- Are they focused and taking their time, or rushing the shot?
- On the rebound attempt, are they going after the ball aggressively?
- Is the student transitioning smoothly to the opposite line?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move the shooting line closer to the basket.
 - Use a smaller ball or lower hoop if available.
 - Remove the rebound/layup follow-up — just take the shot and rotate.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Hold students to shooting from the actual free throw line.
 - Encourage them to set their feet before shooting — don't let them rush.

- Allow the follow-up layup attempt.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add light competitive pressure — track how many each line makes in a round.
 - Require the follow-up layup attempt if they miss.
 - Encourage proper pre-shot routine (dribble, breathe, aim).

Phrases to Use

- "Set your feet before you shoot. Take a breath."
 - "Bend your knees — don't just use your arms."
 - "Elbow in, follow through, hold it until it goes in."
 - "If you miss, go get it — that's part of the drill!"
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Skill Drill: Rainbow Passing (Lob Pass)

Skill Focus	Touch and arc control Passing variation Soft hands receiving
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1 — Setup

- Students work in pairs — one ball per pair.
- Partners stand roughly 8–12 feet apart facing each other.
- If balls are limited, pairs rotate through the drill in small groups.

2 — What They'll Do

- Players pass the ball back and forth using a high-arc lob (rainbow) motion.
- The ball should travel in an arc — up and over — not in a flat line.
- The receiver catches the ball softly and returns with the same arc pass.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the ball traveling in a true arc, or is the student throwing flat?
- Are students using a controlled, soft release — not throwing hard?
- Is the receiver using soft hands to catch (not slapping or batting)?
- Are students maintaining appropriate spacing (not too close or too far)?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use handballs, or smaller foam balls that are easier to grip and arc.
 - Reduce distance between partners.
 - Focus only on the arc motion — catching doesn't have to be perfect yet.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require the ball to clearly arc over an imaginary line or physical marker (cone, etc.).
 - Have partners call 'ready' before throwing so the receiver is prepared.
- **5th–6th:**

- Add a challenge: receiver must catch with one hand only.
- Increase distance slightly and require a higher arc.
- Introduce game context: 'This is what you use to pass over a defender.'

Phrases to Use

- "Make a rainbow with the ball — up and over!"
- "Soft hands — imagine you're catching an egg."
- "Don't throw hard. Control is the goal here."
- "Watch the ball all the way into your hands."

Skill Drill: Bounce Passing

Skill Focus	Passing accuracy Proper receiving technique Ball control
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1 — Setup

- Students work in pairs, standing 5–6 feet apart.
- Each pair has 1 basketball (rotate if limited).
- Students face each other in a stationary position — no movement required.

2 — What They'll Do

- Players pass the ball back and forth using a single bounce pass.
- The ball should bounce once and arrive at the partner's chest level after the bounce.
- The receiver uses soft hands and brings the ball to their chest after catching.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Does the ball bounce once and arrive at chest height — not too short, not too far?
- Are students stepping into the pass with their non-dominant foot?
- Is the receiver using soft hands, or are they slapping/clapping at the ball?
- Are students pushing through the pass (thumbs down on release), or just lobbing?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Reduce distance to 3–4 feet so the bounce arrives cleanly.
 - Allow students to toss with both hands (two-hand bounce pass).
 - Focus only on one bounce — catching form can be simplified.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Emphasize stepping with the opposite foot on the pass.
 - Prompt the 'thumbs down' release cue.
 - Add a target on the floor (cone or tape mark) for students to aim the bounce at.

- **5th–6th:**
 - Require the pass to hit a specific floor target (e.g., 2/3 of the way to partner) - use Dots or bean bags to mark.
 - Add movement: both players shuffle side to side while passing.
 - **Introduce a concept:** 'When do you use a bounce pass in a game?'

Phrases to Use

- "Aim for the floor — two-thirds of the way to your partner."
 - "Step into it — don't just use your arms."
 - "Thumbs down on the release!"
 - "Soft hands — bring it in, don't swat at it."
 - "No clapping to catch!"
-

Skill Drill: Side-by-Side Passing

Skill Focus

Timing and coordination | Passing in motion | Ball control

1 — Setup

- Set up a start cone and an end cone roughly 15–20 yards apart.
- Students pair up with 1 ball per pair.
- Partners line up side-by-side at the start cone, both facing the end cone.

2 — What They'll Do

- Partners move together from start to end cone at the same pace.
- One player dribbles 3 times, then makes a bounce pass to their partner.
- Partner receives the ball, dribbles 3 times, and bounce passes back.
- The pattern repeats until the pair reaches the end cone, then they reset or repeat on the way back.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Are partners staying side-by-side, or is one pulling ahead?
- Is the pass timed well — not too early, not when the partner isn't ready?
- Is the dribble count consistent (3 touches before passing)?
- Is the student in control of the ball while also moving forward?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Have students walk instead of jog.
 - Allow students to stop the ball before passing (no moving pass required).
 - Reduce to 1–2 dribbles before passing to simplify.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Add a jog pace — partners must stay even as they move.

- Enforce 3 dribbles before passing — count aloud if needed.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require a one-touch pass (receive and immediately pass back, no dribbles).
 - Increase to a full run pace.
 - Use non-dominant hand for dribbling.

Phrases to Use

- "Stay side-by-side — match your partner's speed!"
 - "Don't pass until your partner is looking at you."
 - "Keep your spacing consistent — not too close, not too far."
 - "3 dribbles, then pass. Don't rush it!"
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Skill Drill: 1–2 Layup Drill

Skill Focus

Passing into motion | Timing | Finishing at the rim

1 — Setup

- Set up 3–5 lines near the key area (similar layout to 4-Line Layups).
- Players pair across adjacent lines — one player will drive, one will pass.
- Place a ball at the front of passing lines.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player from one line drives toward the basket.
- A player from the adjacent line delivers a bounce pass to the cutter.
- The cutter receives the pass and finishes with a layup.
- If the pass is poor, the play is reset and redone.
- After the attempt, both players rotate to the back of the next line.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the passer timing the throw to hit the cutter in stride — not too early or late?
- Is the cutter calling for the ball or showing a target hand?
- Is the layup finish clean — two steps, correct hand, using the backboard?
- Are students communicating with each other, or working independently?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Shorten the distance from the basket.
 - Allow the driver to stop and catch before going up for the layup.
 - The coach can act as the passer so students focus only on the finish.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Encourage the cutter to show a target hand for the pass.

- Require the bounce pass — no lob or chest pass.
- Walk through the timing slowly at first, then increase speed.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require a one-touch finish — receive and go up in one fluid motion.
 - Add a passive defender near the basket.
 - Time the drill: how many successful layups can a pair land in 60 seconds?

Phrases to Use

- "Passer — wait until the cutter is moving, then lead them with the pass."
 - "Show your hand, cutter — give the passer a target."
 - "Catch it in stride — don't stop. Keep your feet moving!"
 - "Nice timing — that's what it looks like in a real game!"
-

Skill Drill: Zig-Zag Dribble

Skill Focus	Ball control Change of direction Agility
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1 — Setup

- Set up a zig-zag line of cones with clear start and end points (cones roughly 4–6 feet apart).
- Students line up at the start cone, each with a basketball.
- Allow enough space between lines so students aren't dribbling into each other.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students take turns dribbling through the cones in a zig-zag pattern.
- At each cone, they change direction while maintaining control of the ball.
- Students must avoid knocking over cones.
- After completing the course, they return to the back of the line.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student using small, controlled touches — not big swings that send the ball away?
- Are they changing direction cleanly at each cone, or going wide?
- Are students using both hands as they change direction, or only one?
- Is the student looking up occasionally, or staring at the ball the entire time?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Widen cone spacing (6–8 feet) so direction changes are gradual.
 - Allow students to carry the ball around cones if dribbling is too difficult.
 - Walk the course first before doing it with a ball.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Tighten cone spacing to 4 feet to require sharper direction changes.

- Require the crossover dribble at each cone.
- No stopping between cones — keep moving.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use only non-dominant hand through the full course.
 - Set a time challenge — beat your previous best.
 - Add a second ball for an advanced hand-coordination challenge.

Phrases to Use

- "Small touches — keep the ball close to your body."
 - "Attack the cone, then change direction. Don't drift around it."
 - "Use the crossover — switch hands at the cone!"
 - "Don't speed up until you're in control!"
-

Skill Drill: Player in the Middle

Skill Focus

Bounce pass and lob pass mechanics | Passing accuracy | Passing under defensive pressure

1 — Setup

- Divide students into groups of 3 or more.
- Each group has 1 ball.
- Two players stand on opposite ends (passers), one player stands in the middle (defender).
- Set clear boundaries for each group to avoid overlap between groups.

2 — What They'll Do

- The two outside players pass the ball back and forth using either a bounce pass or lob pass.
- The player in the middle attempts to intercept or deflect the pass.
- Groups work toward completing 10 successful passes in a row.
- If the defender intercepts the ball, they switch places with the player who made the bad pass.
- After each round or successful set of 10, all three players rotate roles.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Are passers creating passing angles, or standing flat-footed?
- Is the passer making quick decisions — not holding the ball too long?
- Is the receiver giving a clear target (showing hands, getting open)?
- Is the defender active and engaged, or just standing in place?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the defender initially — focus on just passing back and forth.

- Reduce the pass count to 5 successful passes before rotating.
- Allow students to stop the ball before passing — no rushed passes required.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce the defender after a few successful rounds without one.
 - Set a 10-pass goal and have groups count aloud.
 - Encourage passers to step to the side for better passing angles.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a second defender for groups that are excelling.
 - Limit to 2-touch: receive, then immediately pass.
 - Require a mix of bounce and lob passes — no repeating the same pass type.

Phrases to Use

- "Move your feet — don't just stand there waiting for the pass!"
 - "Make the pass quick — the longer you hold it, the easier it is to intercept."
 - "Show your hands — give your partner a target!"
 - "Defender — stay active, move your feet, make them think!"
-

Skill Drill: Octopus Layup

Skill Focus

Eye tracking and focus under distraction | Offensive decision-making | Hand-eye coordination

1 — Setup

- Set up 3–5 lines near the key.
- One coach or responsible player stands near the basket as the 'defender' holding 2 pool noodles.
- Each line has a basketball at the front.
- Optional: add a second defender or a real goalkeeper for increased difficulty.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player in line dribbles toward the basket for a layup.
- As they approach, the 'defender' uses pool noodles to distract — waving them in the air, blocking passing lanes, or moving toward the ball.
- The shooter must stay focused and complete the layup despite the distraction.
- After shooting, the player retrieves their ball and returns to the back of the line.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student keeping their eyes on the basket, or flinching at the pool noodles?
- Does the student slow down or hesitate when the defender approaches?
- Is the layup form staying consistent under distraction?
- Are students taking a controlled approach, or panicking and rushing the shot?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the defender or have the defender stand completely still (just noodles extended).
 - Move the starting point closer to the basket.

- Allow students to stop and shoot rather than completing a moving layup.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Have the defender move noodles but stay in one position — no stepping toward the shooter.
 - Encourage students to take 2 attempts if they miss due to distraction.
 - Remind students the noodles won't hit them — focus on the basket.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Defender can move within a designated zone (not step in the shooter's path).
 - Add a second pool noodle defender.
 - Require non-dominant hand layup for additional challenge.

Phrases to Use

- "Eyes on the basket — don't watch the noodles!"
- "Trust your approach. You know where the basket is — go get it!"
- "Defender — wave those noodles, don't touch the shooter!"
- "Soft finish — even with pressure, keep it controlled."
- "Don't slow down. Commit to the layup!"

Skill Drill: Zig-Zag Defense

Skill Focus

On-ball defensive footwork | Staying in front of the ball handler |
Defensive stance under pressure

1 — Setup & Materials

- Set up a zig-zag line of cones down the length of the court — cones roughly 5–6 feet apart, alternating left and right.
- Pair students up — one offensive player (dribbler), one defensive player.
- The offensive player starts at the first cone with a basketball. The defender sets up directly in front of them in a defensive stance.
- Run multiple pairs simultaneously down parallel lanes so wait times stay short.
- Students switch roles after completing one full run through the course.

2 — What They'll Do

- The offensive player dribbles through the zig-zag course, changing direction at each cone.
- The defensive player slides alongside in a low defensive stance, working to stay in front of the dribbler at every change of direction.
- The defender's goal is NOT to steal the ball — the goal is to maintain position and force the dribbler to slow down or change direction.
- At each cone, the dribbler changes direction and the defender must react, drop-step, and re-establish position.
- After completing the course, both players jog back to the start and switch roles.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the defender staying low in their stance — knees bent, back flat — or standing tall and upright?
- Are the defender's feet sliding (never crossing) — or are they taking running steps and losing their defensive position?
- Is the defender reacting to the dribbler's hips and torso — not just their eyes or the ball?
- Is the defender maintaining an arm's-length distance — close enough to apply pressure, not so close they get beaten on a single step?
- When the dribbler changes direction, does the defender drop-step and recover — or lunge and lose balance?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the dribble — the offensive player simply walks the zig-zag course and the defender practices sliding alongside.
 - Widen the cone spacing to 8–10 feet so direction changes are gradual.
 - Focus only on the defensive stance — bent knees, hands out — rather than footwork complexity.
 - Coach can walk alongside the defender and narrate: 'Slide... slide... now change!'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce the dribble at a slow-to-moderate pace.
 - Require the defender to call out 'Stance!' at each cone as a self-check reminder to reset their position.
 - Tighten cone spacing to 5 feet so direction changes come faster.
 - Emphasize the drop-step: 'When they go right, your left foot drops back first — then slide.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Allow the offensive player to add hesitation moves and change of pace — not just direction changes at cones.
 - Challenge defenders: allow the offense to attempt a shot at the end of the course — the defender must close out and contest.
 - Add competitive pressure: if the defender gets beaten (dribbler gets two steps past them), the dribbler earns a point.
 - Debrief after: 'What did the dribbler do that was hardest to defend? What adjustment did you make?'

Phrases to Use

- "Stay low! If you're standing tall, you're not in a defensive stance."
- "Slide your feet — don't cross them. Crossed feet = easy to beat."
- "Watch the hips — not the ball, not their eyes. The hips tell you where they're going."
- "Arm's length away — close enough to reach them, far enough they can't blow past you."
- "Drop-step when they change direction. Left foot first if they go right."
- "Your job isn't to steal it — your job is to stay in front."

Skill Drill: Slide & Recover

Skill Focus

Defensive lateral slide footwork | Defensive stance fundamentals | Transition from slide to sprint recovery

1 — Setup & Materials

- Place two cones roughly 10–12 feet apart to mark the width of a defensive lane — this represents the width a defender must cover on the court.
- Set up multiple lanes side by side so several students can work simultaneously.
- No basketball is needed for this drill — it is pure footwork.
- Students line up at the first cone in their lane, one per lane.
- Coach (or student leader) stands at the side and calls out commands or uses a whistle to signal changes.

2 — What They'll Do

- The student starts in a defensive stance at the left cone — feet wide, knees bent, back flat, hands active at their sides.
- On the coach's signal, the student slides laterally to the right cone without crossing their feet.
- Upon reaching the right cone, they hold their stance for one beat, then slide back to the left cone.
- The drill runs continuously back and forth for the designated time (15–20 seconds per set).
- Recovery component: on the coach's call of 'Sprint!' the student immediately sprints forward 5–6 steps (simulating helping on a drive), then backpedals back to the cone line and resumes sliding.
- Repeat for 2–3 sets with brief rest between each.

3 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student maintaining a true defensive stance throughout — or gradually standing up as they fatigue?
- Are feet staying wide and never crossing — or are students taking running steps instead of slides?
- Is the student's weight on the balls of their feet — or flat-footed and slow to react?

- On the sprint-recover, does the student transition quickly and smoothly — or hesitate before moving?
- Are students keeping their hands active (up and out) — or letting them drop to their sides?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the sprint-recover component entirely — focus only on the lateral slide.
 - Shorten the cone distance to 6–8 feet.
 - Coach slides alongside students and narrates the movement: 'Bend your knees... slide... slide... hold!'
 - Use a verbal rhythm to help students stay low: 'Down-2-3, slide-2-3' in a steady beat.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use the full cone distance (10–12 feet).
 - Run 2 sets of 15 seconds with a 10-second rest — introduce the physical demand gradually.
 - Add the sprint-recover once students are comfortable with the slide.
 - Have students self-check at each cone: 'Am I still low? Are my feet wide?'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Increase cone distance to 12–14 feet and run 3 sets of 20 seconds.
 - Add a reaction component: instead of a whistle, the coach points left or right and the student reacts — no predictable pattern.
 - Introduce a 'closeout' finish: after the sprint-recover, the student must sprint to a cone 8–10 feet away and close out with short choppy steps and a hand up.
 - Challenge: can students maintain their stance quality in the third set as well as the first?

Phrases to Use

- "Start low, stay low. The moment you stand up, you're slow."
- "Wide feet — if your feet are together, you have no base."
- "Don't cross your feet. Slide-together-slide, not step-step."
- "Hands active — up and out. A defender with their hands down is a statue."
- "Sprint! Go! Now back — get your stance back before you slide again."
- "Tired? Good. Defenders have to work. Stay in it."

Games - Basketball

Basketball Games

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Game: Dribble Knockout

 **Reference Video:** Dribble Knockout — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0_pPYnND1-w

Skill Focus

Ball control under pressure | Spatial awareness | Eyes-up dribbling

1 — Setup

- Number 6 playing areas 1 through 6 across the court or blacktop.
- Mark each area with cones to create a clearly defined circle (roughly 8–10 feet in diameter).
- Split students into lines, one line per numbered court.
- Each student in line will need access to a basketball when it's their turn.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player from each line grabs a ball and dribbles inside their circle.
- Players dribble to protect their own ball while simultaneously trying to knock opponents' balls out of the circle.
- If a player's ball is knocked outside the circle, they are out — they hand the ball to the next person in their line.
- The game is played King of the Court style: the winner moves one court closer to Court 1 (the top), and the loser moves one court closer to Court 6 (the bottom).
- Play continues with the next players in line stepping into each circle.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are students keeping their head up, or staring at their ball?
- Is the dribble staying low and controlled, or high and loose?
- Are students using their body to shield the ball, or leaving it exposed?
- Are students tracking multiple opponents at once, or focusing only on one?
- Are students staying within the circle boundaries?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use larger circles so students have more space and less immediate contact pressure.
 - Allow students to walk while dribbling instead of jogging or running.
 - Reduce to 2–3 players per circle maximum.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the dribble — any student who picks up their ball is automatically out.
 - Remind students to shield with their body, not push with their hands.
 - Run 2–3 shorter rounds to keep rotation moving fast.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Shrink the circle slightly to increase difficulty.
 - Require non-dominant hand dribbling for one full round.
 - Challenge winners at Court 1 to a final 1v1 round.

Phrases to Use

- "Eyes up — you can't protect your ball if you're staring at it!"
- "Use your body to shield — not your hands. No pushing!"
- "Stay low. Lower dribble = harder to knock away."
- "Move! Standing still makes you an easy target."
- "If your ball goes out, hand it off fast — keep the game moving!"

Game: Hot Shots

 **Reference Video: Hot Shots** — <https://youtu.be/kijouxti20g>

Skill Focus

Shooting fundamentals | Shot selection by distance | Dribbling to a spot

1 — Setup

- Set up 3 cones on each side of both court halves — 6 cones per half, 12 total.
- Position cones at varied distances: inside the key, just outside the key, and behind the three-point line.
- One student per cone forms a line behind it.
- Each student will need a basketball when it is their turn to shoot.

2 — What They'll Do

- On the whistle, one player from each line dribbles up to their cone and shoots for 30 seconds.
- Scoring zones: Inside the key = 1 point, Just outside the key = 2 points, Behind the three-point line = 3 points.
- Shooters rebound their own shots and keep shooting until the whistle blows.
- When the whistle sounds, the shooter passes to the next person in line and goes to the back.
- Lines accumulate points each round — the line with the most total points wins.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are students selecting shots they can reasonably make, or always going for the high-point zone?
- Is the shooting form consistent — bent knees, elbow in, follow through?
- Are students rebounding quickly and getting back to shoot, or losing time?
- Is the dribble approach controlled, or are students rushing and losing the ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Limit shooting to inside the key only — remove far-range zones.
 - Use a lower hoop or a smaller ball if available.
 - Allow students to shoot from a standstill (no dribble approach required).
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Encourage students to choose their shooting zone strategically.
 - Prompt them to rebound immediately — time is limited.
 - Require at least 1 dribble before shooting.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Encourage shot selection discussion before the round: 'Where are you going to shoot from and why?'
 - Require students to dribble to their spot before shooting — no stationary shooting.
 - Add a bonus: 2 consecutive makes = earn an extra point.

Phrases to Use

- "Pick your spot — where can YOU make a shot from?"
- "Rebound fast! You lose seconds standing around."
- "Bent knees, elbow in, follow through — every shot."
- "Don't just go for the 3 — make the shots you can make!"

Game: Kingpin

 **Reference Video: Kingpin** — <https://youtu.be/kijouxti20g>

Skill Focus

Underhand rolling mechanics | Opposite-foot stepping | Accuracy and aim

1 — Setup

- Spread 6 bowling pins (or tall cones) across the basketball court.
- Place a hula hoop or circle of cones around each pin — this is the Kingpin's zone.
- Assign 1 student as the 'Kingpin' guard for each pin.
- Split remaining students to different sides of the court as rollers/throwers.

2 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Students take turns trying to knock down a pin by shooting a basketball at the cone toward it.
- The Kingpin must keep their feet outside the circle — they can only use their feet to block.
- If a pin is knocked down, the student who knocked it down trades places with the Kingpin and becomes the new guard.
- Suggested round progression:
- Round 1: Underhand rolling with 3 Kingpins (focus on stepping with the opposite foot).
- Round 2: Underhand rolling with 2 Kingpins.
- Round 3: Underhand rolling with 1 Kingpin.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Is the student stepping with their opposite foot when rolling (right hand = left foot forward)?
- Is the roll controlled and aimed, or just thrown hard in the general direction?
- Is the Kingpin staying outside the circle, or creeping inside?
- Are students waiting for their turn and resetting properly between rolls?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Start with 4–5 Kingpins so there are more targets and shorter wait times.
 - Focus only on underhand rolling — no throwing yet.
 - Use larger, lighter balls that are easier to control and aim.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the opposite-foot step — pause and demonstrate if needed.
 - Use the round progression as designed: start with 3 Kingpins and reduce.
 - Encourage students to aim, not just throw hard.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Introduce overhand throwing in later rounds for added difficulty.
 - Reduce to 1 Kingpin faster to create more competition.
 - Add a rule: rollers must roll from behind a designated distance line.

Phrases to Use

- "Step with your opposite foot — right hand, left foot forward!"
- "Aim for the base of the pin, not the top."
- "Kingpin — feet outside the circle! You can only use your feet."
- "Control the roll. Slow and accurate beats fast and wild."

Game: Dribble Tag

 **Reference Video:** Dribble Tag — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mQ63CmS0W8s>

Skill Focus

Dribbling under pressure | Ball control while moving | Spatial awareness and agility

1 — Setup

- Split students into lines of 3–4.
- Place one hula hoop flat on the ground at each court.
- The first person in each line grabs a ball; one person starts as the tagger (no ball).
- After all players in the line have had a turn, the group rotates to a new court.

2 — What They'll Do

- The tagger tries to tag the dribbler while both move around the outside of the hula hoop.
- The dribbler must maintain their dribble the entire time while avoiding the tagger.
- If the dribbler is tagged, they become the new tagger.
- Roles switch back and forth for 30 seconds, then the whistle blows and the next pair goes.
- Neither player may step inside or through the hula hoop — movement is around it only.
- After everyone in the line has had a turn, the group rotates to a new court.

2 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the dribbler maintaining their dribble while changing direction, or picking up the ball?
- Is the student keeping their head up to track the tagger?
- Is the dribbler using the hula hoop as a shield/barrier strategically?
- Is the tagger being aggressive and active, or just following at a distance?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow the dribbler to walk instead of run.

- Use a larger hula hoop so there's more space to maneuver.
- Remove the dribble requirement — students can carry the ball for this age group.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the dribble — if the student picks up the ball, they are tagged automatically.
 - Set 30-second rounds with a whistle to keep the energy high.
 - Remind taggers to move decisively, not just walk.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require dribbling with non-dominant hand only.
 - Shorten the round to 20 seconds to increase urgency.
 - Add a rule: the dribbler must complete a full loop around the hoop before the tagger can tag them.

Phrases to Use

- "Keep your dribble going — the moment you stop, you're an easy tag!"
- "Use the hula hoop! Stay on the other side of it from the tagger."
- "Head up — watch the tagger, not the ball."
- "Taggers: be fast and decisive. Don't just follow!"

Game: Lightning

 **Reference Video: Lightning** — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MyatveNZh_0

Skill Focus

Shooting under pressure | Free throw form | Quick rebounding and follow-up

1 — Setup

- Use two basketballs.
- The entire group lines up in a single straight line at the free throw line.
- The first two players each hold a basketball to start.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player shoots from the free throw line. The second player shoots immediately after.
- The first shot must be taken from the free throw line — after that, players can shoot from anywhere.
- If a player makes their shot before the person directly behind them makes theirs, they pass to the next player in line and go to the back.
- If the person behind you makes their shot before you do, you are eliminated.
- The last player standing wins.

2 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Are students taking a composed shot, or rushing and throwing wildly?
- Are students rebounding quickly and getting back up for the follow-up?
- Is the student aware of where the person behind them is in the shooting process?
- Are eliminated students stepping back quickly and safely to keep the game moving?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use a lower hoop or a closer shooting line.

- Use a smaller ball.
- Use a 'Top 5 Rule' — the round ends when 5 players remain, avoiding long wait times for eliminated players.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the free throw line for the first shot — no stepping in.
 - Remind students to rebound their own shot immediately.
 - Run the 'Top 5 Rule' to maintain engagement for eliminated players.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Full rules as described — no modifications needed.
 - Add intensity: narrate the final 3 players to build excitement.
 - Optional: require the first shot to be a free throw with proper form (no jump shots from the line).

Phrases to Use

- "Take a breath — don't rush your shot just because there's pressure!"
- "Rebound fast! Get back up as soon as it goes in or out."
- "You know where the person behind you is — keep moving."
- "Make your shot, pass it quick, get to the back of the line!"

Game: Team Eleven

 **Reference Video:** Team Eleven — <https://youtu.be/DW2cfsCJxiU>

Skill Focus

Elbow shooting form | Shot selection | Team scoring strategy

1 — Setup

- Two teams compete on one half of the court.
- Each team forms a single line.
- No additional equipment needed beyond one basketball per team.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first shooter on each team steps to the elbow (where the free throw line meets the key).
- Shot 1 must be taken from the elbow — if made, it is worth 2 points.
- Shot 2 can be taken from anywhere on the court — if made, it is worth 1 point.
- Teams alternate shooters, with each player shooting both shots before the next player goes.
- The first team to reach exactly 11 points wins the round.

2 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Are students using proper elbow shooting form — set feet, elbow in, follow through?
- On Shot 2, are students choosing shots they can make, or going for difficult attempts?
- Are teammates supporting and encouraging each other?
- Are students tracking the score and understanding how close they are to 11?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move the shooting line closer — shoot from the near edge of the key instead of the elbow.

- Reduce the winning score to 7 points for shorter rounds.
- Use a smaller ball or lower hoop if available.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Hold Shot 1 to the elbow — walk students to the correct spot before the round starts.
 - Encourage Shot 2 from a realistic distance — not from half court.
 - Let teams track their own score: 'How many do you have? How many do you need?'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Full rules as described.
 - Add a strategy element: 'Do you take a risky 1-point shot or play it safe?'
 - Run multiple simultaneous Team Eleven games if space allows.

Phrases to Use

- "Elbow shot first — feet set, elbow in, follow through!"
- "Pick a second shot you can actually make. Smart choices win this game."
- "How many does your team have? What do you need to win?"
- "Cheer your teammates on — this is a team game!"

Game: Dribbling Obstacle Course

 **Reference Video:** Dribbling Obstacle Course — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XrYj_VW-2vc

Skill Focus

Dominant and non-dominant hand dribbling | Crossover and speed dribbling | Advanced ball handling

1 — Setup

- Set up 5 stations across the court using hula hoops and cones.
- Each station targets a different dribbling skill (see below).
- Students are spread across stations and rotate one station to the right after completing each loop.
- Station 1 — Loop: Dribble with either hand around three hula hoops and dribble back.
- Station 2 — Speed: Dribble as fast as possible while maintaining control.
- Station 3 — Weave: Use a crossover dribble (right and left hand) while weaving between cones.
- Station 4 — Stationary: Stand inside a hula hoop and complete 5 dribbles right hand, 5 left hand, 5 crossovers.
- Station 5 — Freestyle: Perform any advanced dribbling moves (between the legs, behind the back, etc.).

2 — What They'll Do

- Students work at their assigned station, completing the designated dribbling task.
- After completing the task (or on the coach's signal), students rotate one station to the right.
- Each student cycles through all 5 stations.
- Stations can be adjusted, added to, or removed based on skill level and available time.

2 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- At Station 1 (Loop): Are students maintaining control around the hoops, or losing the ball on turns?
- At Station 2 (Speed): Is the student staying in control at speed, or sacrificing form for pace?
- At Station 3 (Weave): Is the crossover happening at each cone, or only sometimes?
- At Station 4 (Stationary): Are students completing the full count — right, left, crossover — without stopping?

- At Station 5 (Freestyle): Are students attempting a skill, or just dribbling in place?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Simplify each station: Loop = walk around hoops carrying ball, Speed = walk-dribble, Weave = walk between cones.
 - Allow 2-hand dribbling at any station.
 - Reduce to 3 stations if 5 is too complex to manage.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require single-hand dribbling at all stations.
 - Enforce crossovers at every cone in Station 3.
 - Give students a target count for Station 4 and hold them to it.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a time challenge — beat your last time.
 - Require **between-the-legs** or **behind-the-back** at Station 5.
 - Non-dominant hand only for a full rotation through all stations.

Phrases to Use

- "Control first, speed second. Don't rush it until you own it."
- "Crossover at every cone — don't skip one!"
- "Station 5 is your time to show off. Try something new!"
- "Fingertips, not palms — dribble like the ball is hot!"
- "Eyes up — even at the stations. Practice it now so it's automatic in games."

Game: Dribble Relay

 **Reference Video:** Dribble Relay — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=08yUCVWYzbY>

Skill Focus

Dominant and non-dominant hand dribbling | Low dribble and fingertip control | Dribbling while multi-tasking

1 — Setup

- Split students into lines of 4.
- Place an equal pile of small equipment (beanbags, cones, etc.) at the far end of each line.
- Each line shares one basketball — the ball is passed to the next player after each turn.

2 — What They'll Do

- One player at a time dribbles down to the pile, bends down to grab one item, and dribbles back.
- Players must keep the ball below waist height and use fingertip control throughout.
- The ball is handed to the next player in line, who then goes.
- The first team to collect all items back to their line wins the round.
- Suggested round progression:
- Round 1: Right-hand dribble only.
- Round 2: Left-hand dribble only.
- Round 3: Crossover dribble; carry the item back tucked under the chin, in a pocket, or held in the free hand.
- Round 4: Backwards dribble.
- Round 5: Behind-the-back dribble.

2 — Assessment (What You Will Look For)

- Is the student keeping the dribble below their waist, or bouncing it high?
- Are students using their fingertips, or slapping with their palm?
- Can students maintain ball control while bending down to grab an item?
- Are students switching hands cleanly between rounds, or reverting to their dominant hand?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to carry the ball instead of dribbling for early rounds.
 - Use a larger, lighter ball that's easier to dribble.
 - Place items closer (shorter dribble distance).
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the dribble — no carrying.
 - Reduce to Rounds 1–3 and add more only if the group is ready.
 - Remind students to keep their eyes up and dribble with control, not speed.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Run all 5 rounds and hold students to the proper technique for each.
 - Round 3 challenge: require students to keep the item balanced somewhere without using their dribbling hand.
 - Add a bonus: if a player loses the ball, they must restart from the beginning of their run.

Phrases to Use

- "Low dribble — keep it below your waist the whole way!"
- "Fingertips! Pretend the ball is a hot potato."
- "Don't stop when you pick up the item — keep that dribble going!"
- "Right hand only this round — no cheating to your left!"
- "Nice! You barely looked down the whole time."

Game: Sink the Ship

Skill Focus

Free throw and layup form | Shooting under competitive pressure | Team strategy and communication

1 — Setup

- Two squads compete simultaneously on the same half of the court.
- Place 2 team markers (cones) at the top of the key — one per team.
- Near the baseline, set up a line of 5–6 cones for each team (these are their 'ships').
- Each team has 1 basketball.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player on each team shoots from the free throw line.
- If they miss, they chase their rebound and may take up to 2 additional attempts (layups or close-range shots).
- If a player makes a basket, they go knock down 1 cone from the opposing team's line.
- After their turn, they pass to the next player on their team.
- The first team to knock down all of the opposing team's cones wins the round.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are students using proper free throw form, or just heaving the ball?
- After a miss, are students going after the rebound aggressively?
- Are teams communicating — tracking whose cones are down and strategizing?
- Is the student handing off the ball promptly, or slowing the team down?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move the shooting line closer to the basket.
 - Use a smaller ball or lower hoop if available.

- Remove the rebound/follow-up rule — just take one shot and rotate.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Hold students to shooting from the free throw line for Shot 1.
 - Allow up to 2 follow-up attempts after a miss.
 - Keep the cone count at 5 per team for reasonably short rounds.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add the strategic twist: if a player makes a basket, they can choose to either knock down an opposing team's cone OR pick up one of their own team's knocked-down cones.
 - This adds a defensive element and deeper strategy.
 - Encourage teams to talk between turns about which option to choose.

Phrases to Use

- "Free throw form — feet set, elbow in, follow through!"
- "If you miss, go get it! Rebounds are part of the game."
- "Team — how many cones do they have left? Talk to each other!"
- "Hand off fast. Your team is counting on you!"
- "5th-6th: think before you act — knock one down or pick one up?"

Game: Around the Arc

 **Reference Video:** Around the Arc — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jh0xU0f6UKY>

Skill Focus

Bounce and chest passing | Dribbling to a shot | Shooting under competitive pressure | Team communication

1 — Setup

- Two squads compete simultaneously.
- Set up poly spots or cones in an arc along one side of the court — one per player.
- The first spot is at the corner of the court; spots arc toward the elbow.
- Each team lines up on their arc, one player per spot.

2 — What They'll Do

- The player at the first spot passes to the second, second to the third, third to the fourth, using bounce passes or chest passes.
- The last player (the shooter) dribbles and takes a shot from anywhere on the court.
- Each shooter gets up to 3 attempts to make their shot.
- The first team whose shooter makes it earns 1 point for that round.
- If neither shooter makes it in their attempts, no point is awarded.
- After each round, all players rotate one spot forward and the shooter goes to the back of the line.
- The team with the most points at the end of the round wins.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are the passes arriving accurately and on time — not lobbed or bounced out of reach?
- Is the shooter receiving the ball cleanly and transitioning into the dribble?
- Are the passers communicating — calling for the ball or signaling they're ready?
- Is the shooter taking a composed shot, or rushing because of competitive pressure?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use more players per team and position them closer together for shorter, easier passes.
 - Allow the shooter to shoot from close range rather than dribbling out.
 - Focus on completing the pass sequence cleanly — de-emphasize the competition.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Hold students to bounce or chest passes — no lobs.
 - Encourage the shooter to pick a realistic spot before dribbling.
 - Alternate scoring by time (e.g., most points in 5 minutes) for a faster pace.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require a specific pass type each round (bounce pass only, then chest pass only).
 - Challenge the shooter to call their shot before dribbling: 'I'm shooting from the elbow.'
 - Reduce shooter attempts to 2 to increase pressure.

Phrases to Use

- "Pass it sharp — your shooter is waiting!"
- "Show your hands — give your passer a target."
- "Shooter: pick your spot before you dribble. Don't wander."
- "Bounce pass or chest pass only — no rainbows!"
- "Communicate! Call for the ball or signal you're ready."

Game: Dribble Freeze Tag

Skill Focus

Dribble control while moving | Spatial awareness | Teamwork (unfreezing)

1 — Setup

- All students spread out within a designated boundary — half court for smaller groups, full court for larger groups.
- Every student except the taggers has a basketball.
- Select 1–2 students as taggers — they do not have a ball.
- Taggers can be identified with a pinnie or colored vest if available.

2 — What They'll Do

- All students dribble freely within the boundaries while avoiding the taggers.
- If a student is tagged, they freeze in place and hold their ball above their head.
- A frozen student can be unfrozen if another dribbling student passes their ball through the frozen student's legs.
- If a student's ball leaves the boundary or they lose control of their dribble, they are automatically frozen.
- Taggers rotate after each round.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are students maintaining their dribble the entire time, or picking up the ball when things get hectic?
- Are students using the full court space, or clustering in one area?
- Are students actively looking to unfreeze teammates, or just self-preserving?
- Are taggers being strategic — cutting off dribblers — or just chasing randomly?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**

- Allow students to walk while dribbling instead of moving at full speed.
- Simplify the unfreeze: a teammate just needs to touch the frozen player's ball (no passing through legs).
- Use only 1 tagger for smaller groups.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the dribble — picking up the ball results in automatic freeze.
 - Keep the 'pass through legs' unfreeze rule.
 - Use 2 taggers for a group of 15+ students.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Shrink the boundary to increase pressure and encounters.
 - Require non-dominant hand dribbling for one full round.
 - Challenge: can the group unfreeze everyone within 60 seconds?

Phrases to Use

- "Keep your head up — know where the tagger is at all times!"
- "Use the whole court! Spread out!"
- "Look for frozen teammates — help them out!"
- "Taggers: be smart. Cut off their path, don't just chase."
- "If your ball goes out, you're frozen — stay in control!"

Game: Color Cone Dribble

Skill Focus

Dribbling fundamentals | Listening and following directions | Reaction time and coordination

1 — Setup

- Scatter colored cones across the court — use at least 3–4 different colors.
- Ensure there are slightly fewer cones than students (creates light competition without crowding).
- Every student has a basketball.
- The coach stands at center court to call colors.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students dribble freely around the court.
- When the coach calls out a color, all students must dribble to and touch a cone of that color as fast as possible.
- Students must maintain their dribble at all times while moving between cones.
- If a student stops their dribble or loses the ball, they freeze for 5 seconds before continuing.
- After each color call, students resume dribbling freely until the next color is called.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are students keeping their dribble while changing direction toward the cone, or picking up the ball?
- Is the student reacting quickly to the color call, or waiting to follow others?
- Are students using the full court, or bunching toward the same cones?
- Is the dribble staying low and controlled while moving at speed?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to carry the ball to the cone instead of dribbling.

- Use only 2–3 colors to keep it simple and reduce decision fatigue.
- Give a longer pause between color calls so students have time to get there.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the dribble — carrying the ball results in a 5-second freeze.
 - Use 4 colors and call them at a moderate pace.
 - Add a fun rule: last student to touch a cone of that color does 5 jumping jacks before rejoining.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Specify which hand to dribble with when calling the color: 'Blue — left hand!'
 - Call colors quickly to challenge reaction time.
 - Add a second layer: call a color AND a movement (e.g., 'Red — backwards dribble to it!').

Phrases to Use

- "Keep dribbling — don't stop when you hear the color!"
- "React fast — go as soon as you hear it!"
- "Spread out! You'll have fewer choices if you all crowd together."
- "Eyes and ears open — color call could come at any second!"
- "Left hand only this round. No switching!"

Game: Sharks & Minnows Dribble

Skill Focus

Dribbling under pressure | Ball protection and shielding | Spatial awareness

1 — Setup

- Define a clear boundary using cones — half court works well for most group sizes. Shrink or expand based on how many students are playing.
- Every student (minnows) has a basketball and starts inside the boundary.
- Select 1–2 students as 'sharks' — they do not have a ball.
- Identify sharks with a pinnie or colored vest if available so players can spot them easily.

2 — What They'll Do

- All minnows dribble freely within the boundary while trying to protect their ball from the sharks.
- Sharks move around the boundary and try to knock minnows' balls out of bounds — using only their hands, no body contact.
- If a minnow's ball is knocked out of bounds, or if they lose control and the ball rolls out, they are eliminated.
- Eliminated players sit on the sideline and watch until the next round begins.
- The last minnow still dribbling inside the boundary wins the round.
- Rotate shark roles between rounds so everyone has a turn.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are minnows keeping their dribble low and protecting the ball with their body — or dribbling high and leaving it exposed?
- Are students using the full boundary space to avoid sharks, or clustering in corners?
- Are students keeping their head up to track the sharks' positions, or staring at the ball?
- Are the sharks being strategic — cutting off space and working together — or just chasing randomly?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use a larger boundary so there's more space to move and fewer immediate collisions.
 - Allow students to walk their dribble instead of moving at full speed.
 - Use only 1 shark to reduce the pressure.
 - Allow eliminated players to rejoin after completing 5 jumping jacks to keep everyone active.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce a real dribble — picking up the ball counts as being eliminated.
 - Use 2 sharks for groups of 12 or more.
 - Remind minnows to use their body to shield — not their free hand to push.
 - Shrink the boundary slightly after each 30 seconds to build intensity.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require non-dominant hand dribbling for the entire round.
 - Shrink the boundary from the start to create immediate pressure.
 - Add a rule: minnows cannot stay in one spot for more than 3 seconds — must keep moving.
 - Challenge: can any minnow survive a full 60-second round against 2 sharks?

Phrases to Use

- "Keep your dribble low — a high bounce is easy to knock away!"
- "Use your body to shield the ball — put yourself between the shark and the ball."
- "Head up! Where are the sharks right now?"
- "Sharks — work together. Cut off their space, don't just chase."
- "Stay in the boundary — if your ball rolls out, you're done!"

Game: 3-Point Around the World

Skill Focus

Shooting from multiple spots | Shot consistency and form | Composure under mild pressure

1 — Setup

- Place 7 poly spots or cones in an arc around the key — starting at one corner, moving through the wings and elbows, ending at the opposite corner.
- Spots should range from just outside the key to beyond the three-point line, depending on the age group.
- Students form a single line. Each player works through the arc independently.
- One ball per player, or share balls with a partner who retrieves rebounds.

2 — What They'll Do

- Players start at Spot 1 (corner) and attempt a shot.
- If they make it, they advance to the next spot.
- If they miss, they get one more attempt from the same spot.
- If they miss the second attempt, they go back one spot (or back to the start — coach's choice).
- The goal is to work through all 7 spots in order and complete the arc.
- The first player to make a shot at every spot wins the round.
- Players can also play individually against their own previous best (how many spots can you complete before missing twice?).

3 — What You Will Look For

- Is the student adjusting their shooting form based on distance — or using the same approach from every spot?
- Are students taking composed shots, or rushing after a first miss?
- Is the student squaring up to the basket at each spot, or shooting off-balance?
- Are students tracking their own progress and spots accurately?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use only 3–4 spots, all positioned close to the basket inside the key.
 - Remove the 'go back a spot' consequence — just allow unlimited attempts at each spot.
 - Use a lower hoop or smaller ball if available.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use 5–6 spots, keeping the farthest spot at the elbow or just outside the key.
 - Apply the 'miss twice = go back one spot' rule.
 - Encourage students to call their shot: 'I'm going for Spot 4.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use all 7 spots including corner threes.
 - Apply the full rule: miss twice = back to the start.
 - Run it as a race between 2 players on opposite sides of the arc — adds competitive pressure.
 - Require proper form at each spot — no jump shots from close range where a set shot would be more consistent.

Phrases to Use

- "Set your feet at every spot. Don't rush the shot."
- "You missed once — slow down, reset, and take a good second shot."
- "Adjust your power for the distance. Far spots need more legs."
- "Bent knees, elbow in, follow through — same form every spot."
- "What spot are you on? Stay focused — don't lose track."

Game: Passing Keepaway

Skill Focus

Bounce pass and chest pass mechanics | Movement off the ball | Decision-making under defensive pressure

1 — Setup

- Divide students into groups of 4–5.
- Each group has 1 basketball.
- Mark a small playing grid for each group using 4 cones — roughly 10x10 feet. Adjust size based on skill level.
- Within each group, 1–2 players start as defenders. The remaining players are passers.

2 — What They'll Do

- Passers work together to keep the ball away from the defenders using only passes — no dribbling allowed.
- Passers may use bounce passes or chest passes.
- Passers must stay within the grid boundaries.
- If a defender intercepts the ball or knocks it out of bounds, they switch roles with the passer who made the bad pass.
- Groups count consecutive successful passes — the goal is to hit 10 in a row.
- After a set of 10 is completed, or after a turnover, rotate defenders.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are passers moving after they pass to create new angles — or standing still and waiting?
- Are passes sharp and targeted, or slow and easy to intercept?
- Are passers making quick decisions, or holding the ball too long?
- Is the receiver showing a target (hands up, calling for the ball) before the pass is made?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**

- Remove the defender initially — focus just on completing passes within the grid.
- Allow students to take 1 dribble before passing if needed.
- Use a larger grid so there's more space to find open passing lanes.
- Reduce the pass goal to 5 consecutive passes.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce 1 defender once the group can complete 5 passes without one.
 - No dribbling allowed — enforce this rule actively.
 - Prompt movement after the pass: 'Pass and move — don't stand still!'
 - Count consecutive passes aloud as a group.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use 2 defenders in a group of 5.
 - Shrink the grid to reduce passing space.
 - Restrict to bounce passes only for one round, then chest passes only for the next.
 - Add a rule: you cannot pass back to the same person who just passed to you.

Phrases to Use

- "Pass and move! If you stand still after the pass, you're useless to your team."
- "Show your hands — give your teammate a target!"
- "Quick passes. The longer you hold it, the easier it is to intercept."
- "Defenders: stay active — hands up, move your feet."
- "Where's the open person? Look before you catch, not after."

Game: 21

Skill Focus

Shooting under pressure | Rebounding and follow-up | Score management and strategy

1 — Setup

- All players share one half of the court. No teams — every player is for themselves.
- One basketball is used.
- All players line up along the free throw line to start.
- Decide before the game starts whether going over 21 sends a player back to 15 (recommended) or back to 0.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player shoots from the free throw line. Every player shoots in order.
- If a player makes their free throw, they immediately get to shoot up to 2 bonus shots from anywhere on the court for 1 point each.
- If the free throw is missed, the player must rebound their own miss. Wherever the ball is rebounded, that is where they shoot their next shot — they may not dribble to reposition.
- All other players race to the rebound on a missed free throw — whoever gets it shoots from where they grabbed it, also without dribbling.
- After the rebound shot, the ball returns to the free throw line and the next player goes.
- First player to reach exactly 21 wins. If a player goes over 21, they drop back to 15.

3 — What You Will Look For

- Are students taking composed free throws, or rushing because of competitive pressure?
- On a missed free throw, are students going after the rebound aggressively?
- Are students making smart shot selections on their bonus shots — picking spots they can make?
- Are students tracking their own score accurately, especially as they approach 21?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move the shooting line closer to the basket.
 - Remove the rebound-and-shoot rule — just rotate turns at the line.
 - Use a 'Top 5' endpoint: end the game when 5 players are still in, so no one waits too long.
 - Use a smaller ball or lower hoop if available.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use the full rules but set the target at 11 instead of 21 for faster rounds.
 - Allow 1 dribble after a rebound before shooting.
 - Enforce the 'drop back to 15' rule — explain it before the game starts.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Full rules as described — target is 21, drop to 15 if you go over.
 - No dribbling after a rebound — shoot from where you catch it.
 - Add the strategic angle: 'You're at 19 — you need exactly 2 more. What shot do you take?'
 - Allow students to intentionally pass up their bonus shots if they're worried about going over.

Phrases to Use

- "What's your score? Always know where you are."
- "You're close to 21 — think before you take that shot. Can you go over?"
- "Rebound fast! Whoever gets that ball gets to shoot."
- "Free throw first — stay calm. The bonus shots come after."
- "Smart choice not taking that shot. Sometimes the best move is to wait."



Soccer

ELP Summer 2026:

Sports Curriculum - Soccer

This section contains the full soccer curriculum for the Expanded Learning Program (ELP) Summer 2026. It is organized across two sub-tabs: one focused on **skill-based drills** and one focused on **soccer games**. All activities include setup instructions, game rules, coaching cues, age-appropriate modifications, and skill focus areas.

Soccer Drills Structured drills targeting individual and partner skill development. Activities are broken into three categories:

- **Dribbling** — Dribble Intro, Lateral Foot Dribble, Foot Switch Dribble, Cone Weave Dribble
- **Shooting** — 4-Line Shots on Goal, 2-Line Penalty Kick, Pool Noodle Shooting, 1-2 Shot Drill
- **Passing** — Ground Pass, Moving Side-by-Side Pass, Gate Passing, Piggy in the Middle

These drills include grade-band modifications (TK–2nd and 3rd–6th) to support differentiated instruction.

Soccer Games Small-sided and modified games designed to reinforce skills in a fun, competitive format. Games include:

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| ● Single Cone Soccer (1st–6th) | ● 4-Goal Scrimmage |
| ● Soccer Ball Tic-Tac-Toe | ● Dribble Knockout |
| ● Center Pin | ● Freeze Tag Dribble |
| ● Soccer Golf | ● Shooting Derby |
| ● Goalie (Gaga) Ball | ● Scrimmage (Modified) |
| ● Corner Ball | ● Numbers Breakaway |
| ● Sharks & Minnows Dribble | ● World Cup |
| ● Rondo | ● Gate Dribble Race |

Some drills and games include a reference video link for coach preview.

More games/drills may be added

Skill Drills - Soccer

Skill Drills - Soccer

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Skill Drill: Dribble Intro

Skill Focus

Ball control | Consistent touch distance | Eyes up

1 — Setup

- Use an open grass field or blacktop with clearly visible sidelines.
- Give each student a soccer ball.
- Have students line up along one sideline with enough space between them to move freely.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students dribble a soccer ball using their dominant foot from one sideline to the other.
- Players face forward and keep their head up the entire time — not looking at the ball.
- Use the inside or top of the foot — coach decides before the drill starts.
- Students stop at the opposite sideline or return — coach's choice.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student looking up, or staring at the ball?
- Are touches consistent — ball staying within one or two steps ahead — or does it keep rolling too far?
- Is the student using the correct part of the foot (inside or top), or kicking awkwardly?
- Are students moving in a relatively straight line, or drifting off course?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to use whichever foot is most comfortable — no dominant foot requirement.
 - Focus only on keeping the ball close — don't worry about head position yet.
 - Use a larger or lighter ball (size 3) if a standard size 4/5 is too difficult to control.

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require students to use their dominant foot.
 - Prompt the 'eyes up' cue frequently — this is the primary skill to reinforce.
 - Have students pick a visual target on the opposite sideline to focus on.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require alternating touches: 2 with dominant foot, 2 with non-dominant, repeat.
 - Add a pace challenge — dribble at a jog while maintaining control.
 - Ask students: 'What does keeping your head up help you see in a real game?'

Phrases to Use

- "Pick a spot on the wall (or fence) and keep your eyes on it the whole way!"
- "Small touches — keep the ball within one big step of your foot."
- "Top of the foot or inside — don't kick it with your toe."
- "Nice! You barely looked down. That's exactly what we're going for."

Skill Drill: Lateral Foot Dribble

Skill Focus

Coordination | Lateral movement | Close ball control

1 — Setup

- Use an open field or blacktop with clear sidelines.
- Give each student a soccer ball.
- Students line up along one sideline facing the same direction — parallel to the line, ready to shuffle sideways.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students shuffle sideways from one sideline to the other while dribbling with small inside-foot taps.
- Feet must not cross — this is a true lateral shuffle movement.
- Players remain facing the same direction throughout.
- At the halfway point or opposite sideline, the coach may signal students to switch direction.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students shuffling with their feet, or are they crossing their feet into a jog?
- Are the touches small and controlled, keeping the ball close to the feet?
- Is the student staying low and in an athletic stance, or standing tall and stiff?
- Is the ball staying at their side as they move laterally, or drifting ahead or behind?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow students to walk the shuffle instead of moving at pace.
 - Let students carry or tap the ball forward lightly if the side-foot tap while shuffling is too complex.
 - Demonstrate the shuffle movement without a ball first, then add the ball.

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Remind students to keep their hips square — facing the same direction the whole way.
 - Require inside-foot taps only — no kicking with the toe.
 - Add a direction change at the midpoint on the coach's whistle.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a hand switch at the midpoint — inside-foot tap with right foot going one direction, left foot on the return.
 - Increase pace — can students shuffle-dribble faster while keeping the ball tight?
 - Ask: 'When would you use lateral dribbling in a real game?' (screening a defender, setting up a pass angle)

Phrases to Use

- "Don't cross your feet — stay in the shuffle!"
- "Keep the ball at your side — not in front of you, not behind you."
- "Small taps! You're not kicking it hard, just guiding it."
- "Stay low — bend your knees like you're playing defense."

Skill Drill: Foot Switch Dribble

Skill Focus

Weak foot development | Rhythm and coordination | Two-footed control

1 — Setup

- Use an open field or blacktop with clear sidelines.
- Give each student a soccer ball.
- Students line up along one sideline with space between them.

2 — What They'll Do

- Students dribble across the field, touching the ball 3 times with their right foot, then switching to the left foot and repeating.
- Encourage students to alternate using the inside and outside of each foot.
- Students stop at the opposite sideline or return — coach's choice.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student completing exactly 3 touches before switching, or losing count?
- Is the switch smooth and intentional, or does the student pause and reset?
- Is the student using both the inside and outside of the foot, or always using the inside?
- Is the ball staying within a controlled distance during the switch?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Reduce to 1–2 touches per foot so the count is simpler.
 - Have students count aloud: '1, 2, 3 — switch!'
 - Don't require inside/outside variation — just switching feet is the goal.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Hold students to exactly 3 touches — reinforce counting.

- Prompt them to keep moving forward without pausing at the switch.
- Introduce the inside/outside variation: 'Every other touch, use the outside of your foot.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Increase to 5 touches per foot for an added challenge.
 - Require deliberate inside/outside alternation on each touch.
 - Add a pace element — can students do it at a jog without losing the count or control?

Phrases to Use

- "Count out loud — 1, 2, 3 — switch!"
- "Don't stop when you switch. Keep moving forward!"
- "Inside, outside, inside — mix it up with each touch."
- "Your weak foot needs practice too. That's the whole point of this one!"

Skill Drill: 4-Line Shots on Goal

Skill Focus

Shooting form | Approach angles | Finishing repetition

1 — Setup

- Set up 4 lines around the penalty area — one at each angle (left corner, left elbow, right elbow, right corner), starting near the top of the box.
- Place a goal at the end of the field (use cones to create a goal if needed).
- Add a goalkeeper if available and appropriate for the group.
- Each line should have a ball at the front.

2 — What They'll Do

- One player at a time steps out from the front of their line, dribbles toward the goal, and takes a shot.
- Students shoot using the instep (laces) or inside of the foot — coach decides.
- If they miss, players get 2 additional attempts (follow-up shots or repositioned attempts).
- After shooting, the player retrieves their ball and rotates to the back of the next line.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student planting their non-kicking foot next to the ball before striking?
- Is the student using the instep or inside of the foot — not toeing the ball?
- Is the approach controlled and deliberate, or are students just running and kicking?
- Are students aiming at the goal, or just shooting in its general direction?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move all 4 lines closer to the goal — remove the full dribble approach.
 - Allow students to shoot from a stopped position (no approach required).
 - Use a larger goal or wider cone target to increase success rate.

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require a short dribble approach (2–3 touches) before shooting.
 - Coach the plant foot: 'Put your left foot next to the ball before you kick!'
 - Reinforce instep or inside-of-foot striking — correct toe kicks in the moment.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require a full dribble from the starting cone before shooting.
 - Specify the target area (low left, low right, etc.) before each round.
 - Add a goalkeeper for all groups.
 - Add a challenge: must score from all 4 lines before moving on.

Phrases to Use

- "Plant foot next to the ball — don't kick with your toe!"
- "Inside of the foot for accuracy, laces for power — pick one."
- "Head down on contact, then look up to see where it went."
- "Approach at an angle — don't run straight at the ball."

Skill Drill: 2-Line Penalty Kick

Skill Focus

Shooting under pressure | Follow-up positioning | Transition after the shot

1 — Setup

- Create 2 lines behind the penalty spot — one per team.
- Place the ball on the penalty spot for each turn.
- Add a goalkeeper if available (rotate the role between students).
- Both lines take turns simultaneously or alternately — coach decides based on space.

2 — What They'll Do

- One player from each line steps to the penalty spot and takes 1 penalty kick.
- If the shot misses or the keeper saves it, the shooter may chase the rebound and attempt 1 follow-up shot.
- After their turn, the player goes to the back of the opposite line (not their own).

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student approaching the ball with a consistent, controlled run-up?
- Is the student picking a target before they approach — or just kicking randomly?
- After a miss, does the student immediately move to follow up, or stand and watch?
- Is the transition to the opposite line happening quickly, or are students lingering?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move the shooting spot closer to the goal.
 - Remove the follow-up rule — just take the kick and rotate.
 - Use a larger goal or wider cone target.
 - Remove the goalkeeper so every kick has a clear, open target.

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the penalty spot — students must shoot from the correct position.
 - Allow the follow-up attempt: 'If you miss, chase it!'
 - Introduce a basic goalkeeper (rotating student role).
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require students to commit to a side before the run-up (no last-second changes).
 - Use a full student goalkeeper who tries to read and save the shot.
 - Add a mental pressure element: announce the score or make it a team competition.

Phrases to Use

- "Pick your spot before you start your run-up. Commit to it."
- "If you miss, don't stop moving — go get the rebound!"
- "Approach at an angle, not straight on."
- "Breathe before you kick. Don't rush it."

Skill Drill: Ground Pass

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy | Proper receiving technique | First touch

1 — Setup

- Students work in pairs — one ball per pair.
- Partners stand 8–10 feet apart, facing each other.
- If balls are limited, pairs rotate in small groups.

2 — What They'll Do

- Players pass the ball back and forth using a firm ground pass with the inside of the foot.
- The receiver uses the inside of their foot to cushion the ball — a soft first touch.
- The receiver brings the ball under control before passing back.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student locking their ankle and passing through the center of the ball?
- Is the pass on the ground and firm — not bouncing or trickling weakly?
- Is the receiver using the inside of their foot to receive, or stopping it with their toe or sole?
- Is the ball being controlled before passing back, or being kicked immediately off a rolling ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Reduce distance to 5–6 feet so the pass is easier to control.
 - Allow students to stop the ball completely before passing back.
 - Focus only on using the inside of the foot — receiving form can come later.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require the ankle to be locked on the pass — demonstrate what it looks like.
 - Prompt the 'cushion' receive: 'Meet the ball softly, don't let it run away from you.'

- Once pairs are consistent, increase the distance to 12–15 feet.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require 2-touch: receive with one touch, pass with the next — no extra touches.
 - Increase distance and require a crisp, firm pass each time.
 - Add a movement element: partners shuffle side to side between passes.

Phrases to Use

- "Lock your ankle — it shouldn't bend when you pass."
- "Pass through the center of the ball, not underneath it."
- "Soft first touch — cushion it like you're catching an egg with your foot."
- "Aim for your partner's feet, not their chest."

Skill Drill: Moving Side-by-Side Pass

Skill Focus

Passing in motion | Timing and coordination | Ball control while moving

1 — Setup

- Set up a start cone and an end cone approximately 10–20 yards apart.
- Students pair up — one ball per pair.
- Partners line up side-by-side at the start cone, both facing the end cone.

2 — What They'll Do

- Partners move together from the start cone to the end cone at the same pace.
- One player takes 2–3 dribble touches, then makes a ground pass to their partner.
- The partner receives the ball, takes 2–3 touches, and passes back.
- The pattern continues alternating until they reach the end cone, then partners reset.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are partners staying side-by-side, or is one pulling ahead of the other?
- Is the pass timed well — arriving when the partner is ready to receive?
- Is the player in possession keeping their head up to track their partner's position?
- Is the receiving touch controlled, or is the ball bouncing away and disrupting the flow?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Have students walk the entire drill — no jogging required.
 - Allow students to stop the ball completely before passing.
 - Reduce to 1–2 touches before passing to simplify.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require a jog pace — partners must match each other's speed.

- Enforce 2–3 touches before passing — count aloud if needed.
- Reinforce the inside-of-foot pass — no toe kicks.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require one-touch passing: receive and immediately pass back with no dribble.
 - Use non-dominant foot only for one full run.
 - Increase pace to a full run and see if pairs can maintain the pattern.

Phrases to Use

- "Stay side-by-side — match your partner's speed!"
- "Pass with the inside of your foot — always."
- "Don't pass until your partner is looking at you and ready."
- "Keep your spacing consistent — not too close, not too far."

Skill Drill: 1-2 Shot Drill

Skill Focus

First-touch finishing | Passing in motion | Timing a run

1 — Setup

- Set up 3–5 lines near the top of the penalty area.
- Place a goal at the end of the field (use cones if no goal is available).
- Add a goalkeeper if the group is ready for it.
- Each line has a ball at the front.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player from one line makes a run toward the goal.
- A player from the adjacent line plays a ground pass (through ball) to the runner.
- The runner receives the pass and takes a first-touch shot on goal.
- If the pass is poor, the play is reset and redone.
- After the attempt, both players rotate to the back of the next line.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the runner timing their run — moving when the pass is ready, not before?
- Is the passer delivering the pass into space for the runner, not behind them?
- Is the runner taking the shot on the first touch, or taking extra touches and losing momentum?
- Is the shot balanced — plant foot planted, striking through the ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Shorten the distance — start lines closer to the goal.
 - Allow the runner to stop the ball and set up before shooting.
 - Coach can act as the passer so students focus only on the finish.

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Require a ground pass — no lobs or bouncy passes.
 - Remind the runner to show a hand or call for the ball.
 - Walk through the timing together before the first live rep.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require a strict one-touch finish — no stopping the ball.
 - Add a passive defender near the goal to create pressure.
 - Time it: how many successful goals can a pair score in 60 seconds?

Phrases to Use

- "Runner — wait for the pass to be on its way, THEN go!"
- "Passer — lead them into space, don't pass to where they are."
- "First touch toward goal — don't kill the momentum."
- "Stay balanced when you shoot. Plant foot, strike through the ball."

Skill Drill: Cone Weave Dribble

Skill Focus

Ball control | Change of direction | Agility

1 — Setup

- Set up a straight line of cones approximately 3 feet apart with a clear start and end point.
- Students line up at the start cone — one ball per student.
- Allow enough room between parallel lines so students are not interfering with each other.

2 — What They'll Do

- Players dribble through the cones in a weave pattern using controlled touches.
- Students alternate feet as they weave through each cone.
- After completing the course, students return to the back of the line.
- If a cone is knocked over or missed, the student redoes the attempt.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are touches small and controlled — ball staying close to the feet — or are students kicking it too far ahead?
- Are students using both feet to weave, or always leading with their dominant foot?
- Are direction changes happening at each cone, or are students going wide around them?
- Is the student maintaining a forward gaze, or staring straight at the ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Widen cone spacing to 5–6 feet so direction changes are gradual and less demanding.
 - Allow students to stop the ball between cones before changing direction.
 - Walk the course first without a ball so students understand the path.

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Tighten spacing to 3 feet for sharper changes of direction.
 - Require alternating feet — check that students aren't always using the same foot.
 - No stopping between cones — keep moving throughout.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require non-dominant foot only for a full run through the course.
 - Add a time challenge — students try to beat their previous time.
 - Require an outside-of-foot touch at every other cone for an extra challenge.

Phrases to Use

- "Small touches — keep the ball right at your foot."
- "Attack the cone, then change direction. Don't drift around it."
- "Use both feet — if you're always using the same foot, slow down and fix it."
- "Don't speed up until you're in control. Speed comes from control, not rushing."

Skill Drill: Piggy in the Middle

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy | Ground and lofted passing mechanics | Passing under defensive pressure | First touch and decision-making

1 — Setup

- Divide students into groups of 3 — one ball per group.
- Two players (passers) stand a short distance apart facing each other.
- One player stands in the middle as the defender ('piggy').
- Define clear boundaries for each group using cones to prevent overlap between groups.

2 — What They'll Do

- The two outside players pass the ball back and forth — ground passes or lofted passes.
- The player in the middle attempts to intercept or block each pass.
- Groups work toward completing 10 successful passes in a row.
- If the defender intercepts the ball, they switch places with the player who made the bad pass.
- After each round or set of 10 successful passes, all three players rotate roles.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are passers moving to create better passing angles, or standing flat-footed?
- Are passes being made quickly, or are players holding the ball too long and making the defender's job easy?
- Is the receiver showing a good first touch — controlling the ball close — or letting it bounce away?
- Is the defender staying active, or just standing in the middle and watching?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Start without a defender — just focus on completing passes back and forth.

- Reduce the goal to 5 successful passes before rotating.
- Allow students to stop the ball fully before passing.
- Use only ground passes.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce the defender after the group has warmed up with a few no-pressure passes.
 - Set a 10-pass goal and have groups count aloud.
 - Encourage passers to step to the side for a better angle before passing.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Limit to 2-touch: one touch to receive, one to pass — no extra dribbles.
 - Add a second defender for groups that are dominating.
 - Require a mix of ground and lofted passes — they can't repeat the same type twice in a row.

Phrases to Use

- "Move your feet — create a better angle before you pass!"
- "Quick pass — the longer you hold it, the easier it is to intercept."
- "Use the inside of your foot for control."
- "Receive softly — cushion it and keep it close."
- "Defender: stay active, keep your feet moving!"

Skill Drill: Pool Noodle Shooting

Skill Focus

Shooting under pressure | Ball control on the approach | Offensive decision-making | Composure with a defender present

1 — Setup

- Set up 3–5 lines of students outside the penalty area — each line has a ball at the front.
- Place a goal at the end of the field (use cones if no goal is available).
- Assign 1 coach or a responsible student as the 'defender' — they hold 2 pool noodles.
- Optional: add a goalkeeper for increased difficulty.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first player in line dribbles toward the goal.
- As they approach the shooting zone, the pool noodle defender waves the noodles to create distraction and attempts to block the shot path — without touching the shooter.
- The shooter focuses on their target and attempts to score.
- After the shot, the player retrieves the ball and returns to the back of their line.
- The next player goes once the previous shot has been taken.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student keeping their eyes on the goal — or flinching and watching the noodles?
- Is the approach controlled with the ball close, or is the student rushing and losing the ball?
- Is the student planting their foot next to the ball before striking?
- Does the student slow down or hesitate when the defender engages — or do they stay committed?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the defender entirely or have them stand completely still (noodles just extended, not moving).

- Move the starting line closer to the goal.
- Allow students to stop and set up before shooting — no moving shot required.
- Use a larger goal or wider cone target.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Defender waves noodles but stays in one position — no stepping toward the shooter.
 - Reassure students: 'The noodles can't hurt you — stay focused on the goal.'
 - Encourage 2–3 controlled touches on the approach before shooting.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Defender can move within a designated zone (no stepping directly into the shooter's path).
 - Add a goalkeeper behind the noodle defender.
 - Require non-dominant foot shooting for an added challenge.
 - Add a time limit: must shoot within 3 seconds of entering the zone.

Phrases to Use

- "Eyes on the goal — don't watch the noodles!"
- "Trust your approach. You know where the goal is — commit to it."
- "Plant your foot, strike through the ball."
- "Defender — wave those noodles, don't touch the shooter!"
- "Control first, then shoot. Don't panic and kick early."

Skill Drill: Gate Passing

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy | First touch and ball control | Movement off the ball | Communication and teamwork

1 — Setup

- Set up multiple small 'gates' using pairs of cones across the field — gates should be 2–3 feet wide.
- Spread gates around the space at varied angles and distances — no two gates should be perfectly lined up.
- Each pair of students shares 1 soccer ball.
- Define a clear boundary to keep all pairs within the playing area.

2 — What They'll Do

- Partners work together to pass the ball through as many gates as possible.
- A gate counts when the ball rolls cleanly through the two cones from one partner to the other.
- After a successful gate pass, partners move to find a new gate to pass through.
- Partners keep moving — they should not camp at one gate.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are passes accurate enough to roll cleanly through the gate — or consistently off target?
- Is the receiving player showing a soft first touch and keeping the ball close?
- Are partners communicating — calling for the ball, pointing to a gate, signaling they're ready?
- Are pairs moving together around the space, or standing in one spot?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Widen gates to 4–5 feet to make them easier targets.

- Allow students to stop the ball before passing — no moving passes required.
- Focus only on completing passes — no scoring or counting required.
- Allow slower movement or even stationary passing to start.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Set a round target: 'See how many gates you can hit in 2 minutes.'
 - Require the inside of the foot for all passes.
 - Prompt movement: 'After you pass, move to a new gate — don't stay put.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Limit to 2-touch: one to receive, one to pass.
 - Require non-dominant foot for all passes in a round.
 - Add passive defenders who roam the space and try to intercept — passers must choose gates away from defenders.

Phrases to Use

- "Use the inside of your foot — control, not power."
- "Soft first touch — keep the ball close after you receive."
- "Eyes up before you pass — find the gate first, then pass."
- "Pass and move! Don't just stand there after you kick it."
- "Call for it! Let your partner know you're ready."

Skill Drill: Speed Dribble vs. Control Dribble

Skill Focus

Speed dribbling vs. close control | Touch distance awareness |
Decision-making — when to push vs. keep tight

1 — Setup

- Use an open field with two clearly marked sidelines or end lines as start and finish points.
- Give each student a soccer ball.
- Students line up along one sideline with enough space between them to move freely.
- Coach explains and demonstrates both modes before the drill starts — this drill is all about contrast, so students need to understand the difference before they try it.

2 — What They'll Do

- Run 1 — Speed Dribble: Students push the ball 2–3 steps ahead and sprint to catch up, repeating the pattern all the way across the field. The ball should stay in front of them and they should be moving at near-full speed.
- Run 2 — Control Dribble: Students bring the ball back across the field using small, tight touches — keeping the ball within one step of their foot at all times. Pace is slow and deliberate.
- After completing both runs, coach leads a brief discussion: 'When would you use each one in a game?'
- Repeat for 2–3 sets, alternating between speed and control each run.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- In the Speed Dribble, is the student actually pushing the ball ahead and sprinting — or just jogging with the ball close?
- In the Control Dribble, are touches genuinely small and tight — or is the student still pushing the ball too far ahead out of habit?
- Can students clearly demonstrate the difference between the two modes — or do both runs look the same?
- In the debrief, can students identify a real-game moment for each mode (e.g., speed when in open space, control when near a defender)?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Focus on the Control Dribble only — 'keep the ball close to your foot' is the key concept at this age.
 - Skip the Speed Dribble for now — running at full speed while tracking a ball ahead is too complex.
 - Use a simple cue: 'Baby steps with the ball — tiny taps!'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Run both versions and draw the contrast clearly.
 - Coach narrates during the Speed Dribble: 'Push it! Now sprint! Push it! Sprint!'
 - During the debrief, give a specific game example: 'If you're running down the wing with no defender near you — speed dribble. If a defender is right in front of you — control dribble.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a mid-drill switch: students start with a speed dribble, and on the coach's whistle mid-run, switch immediately to a control dribble — and vice versa.
 - Challenge: can students transition between the two without breaking stride or losing the ball?
 - Ask: 'What part of the game did we practice today — and when would you actually use this?'

Phrases to Use

- "Speed dribble — push it ahead and SPRINT. Don't jog to it."
- "Control dribble — ball stays within one step. Tiny touches."
- "Feel the difference? One is about distance, one is about safety."
- "Open space with no one near you — push it and go. Defender close — keep it tight."
- "Switch! Now control it. Keep that ball close!"

Skill Drill: Defensive Tracking / Shadow Run

Skill Focus

Defensive footwork and recovery | Staying goal-side of an attacker | Lateral and sprint movement off the ball

1 — Setup

- No soccer ball is needed for this drill — it is pure movement and positioning.
- Pair students up. One student is the attacker, one is the defender.
- Use a section of the field roughly 20 yards wide and 15 yards long — mark boundaries with cones if needed.
- The attacker starts at one end, the defender starts one step behind them and slightly to the goal side.
- Run multiple pairs simultaneously across the field.

2 — What They'll Do

- The attacker jogs, shuffles, sprints, and changes direction freely within the marked area — they are trying to lose the defender.
- The defender's job is to stay within one large step of the attacker at all times, always keeping themselves between the attacker and the goal (goal-side position).
- The defender uses a mix of shuffles, backpedals, and short sprints to track — they should never turn their back to the attacker.
- The drill runs for 20–30 seconds, then players switch roles.
- No tackling, no contact — this is purely about positioning and footwork.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the defender maintaining goal-side position — keeping themselves between the attacker and the goal — or getting turned and chasing from behind?
- Is the defender staying on their toes and reacting quickly to direction changes — or flat-footed and slow to respond?
- When the attacker sprints, does the defender immediately sprint to recover — or jog and lose the gap?
- Is the defender watching the attacker's hips and torso — not just their feet — to read movement early?
- Is the defender staying within one step throughout — or frequently losing contact and scrambling back?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Have students walk instead of jog or sprint — the goal is understanding goal-side positioning, not athleticism.
 - Coach demonstrates the concept first: 'I stay between you and the goal — watch where I go as you move.'
 - Use a simplified cue: 'Stay between your partner and the big cone (the goal).'
 - Reduce the area to a smaller 10x10 zone so tracking distances are short.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Allow jogging pace — no full sprints yet.
 - Pause the drill once mid-set to check positions: 'Freeze! Defender — are you between your partner and the goal? Show me.'
 - Introduce the vocabulary: 'goal-side' — defenders should be able to say it and point to where they should be.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Allow full-speed direction changes by the attacker.
 - Add a ball in the second round — now the attacker dribbles and the defender applies the same tracking principles with live ball pressure.
 - Debrief: 'What did the attacker do that was hardest to track? What adjustment worked?'
 - Introduce the concept of 'pressure, cover, balance' — the defender is the pressure player.

Phrases to Use

- "Stay goal-side — keep yourself between your partner and the goal at all times."
- "Don't turn your back. Shuffle, backpedal, sprint — but always face them."
- "Watch the hips. The hips tell you where they're going before their feet do."
- "When they sprint — you sprint. Don't jog to recover."
- "Freeze! Where are you right now? Are you between them and the goal?"

Skill Drill: Jockeying Drill

Skill Focus

Defensive patience — delaying the attacker | Steering the attacker toward the sideline | Staying on your feet instead of diving in

1 — Setup

- Mark a channel roughly 10 yards wide and 20 yards long using cones — one channel per pair.
- One student starts at one end as the attacker with a soccer ball.
- The other student starts as the defender, standing 2–3 yards in front of the attacker.
- A line of cones at the far end of the channel represents the goal — the attacker is trying to reach it.
- Run multiple channels simultaneously.

2 — What They'll Do

- The attacker dribbles toward the far end (the goal line) — they are trying to get past the defender or reach the end line.
- The defender jockeys: they retreat slowly in a low stance, staying in front of the attacker, with their body angled to steer the attacker toward one side of the channel.
- The defender's goal is NOT to win the ball — it is to slow the attacker down and force them toward the sideline cone.
- The defender must stay on their feet — no lunging, diving in, or tackling.
- After reaching the end of the channel, or after a set time (15–20 seconds), players switch roles.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the defender staying patient — retreating slowly — or rushing in and getting beaten?
- Is the defender's body angled to steer the attacker toward the sideline — or facing them square-on with no steering?
- Is the defender staying low with bent knees and active feet — or standing tall and flat-footed?
- Is the defender keeping their eye on the ball — specifically the space between the ball and the attacker's foot — to time any eventual challenge?
- Is the attacker being forced wide — or running straight through the center of the channel with no resistance?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the competitive element — defenders just practice the stance and retreat movement without an active attacker.
 - Coach acts as the attacker moving slowly toward the student while they practice jockeying backward.
 - Focus only on the low stance and backward shuffle — body angle can come later.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use a live attacker at a slow-to-moderate dribble pace.
 - Teach the angled body position before starting: 'Stand at an angle — right foot forward if you want to push them left.'
 - Reinforce patience: 'Your job is to slow them down, not win the ball. Be patient.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Allow the attacker to use speed changes and feints — not just straight dribbling.
 - Add a transition: after successfully jockeying the attacker to the sideline, the defender may attempt a clean tackle.
 - Debrief: 'Why is jockeying more effective than diving in? What happens when a defender dives in and misses?'

Phrases to Use

- "Slow down — don't rush in. Make them come to you."
- "Angle your body. You're a wall that's pushing them sideways."
- "Stay low — if you stand tall, one quick move and they're past you."
- "Watch the ball, not their face. The ball tells you when to move."
- "Patient. Patient. Patient. Wait for your moment."
- "Your job right now is to delay. That's it. No tackle yet."

Skill Drill: 1v1 Defending

Skill Focus

Live 1v1 defensive pressure | Legal defending — no fouling | Body positioning and containing the attacker

1 — Setup

- Set up multiple small fields using cones — each field is roughly 10 yards wide with a small 2-cone goal at one end.
- Pair students up — one attacker, one defender per field.
- The attacker starts with the ball at the far end from the goal. The defender starts 3 yards in front of them.
- Run all pairs simultaneously. Coach rotates between fields to give feedback.
- After each round (20–30 seconds or when a goal is scored/ball goes out), students switch roles.

2 — What They'll Do

- The attacker tries to dribble past the defender and score through the small goal.
- The defender applies everything from the Shadow Run and Jockeying Drill — goal-side position, low stance, patience, steering.
- The defender tries to either: contain the attacker and keep them away from goal, or win the ball cleanly without fouling.
- No pushing, shirt-pulling, tripping, or using arms to block — clean defensive pressure only.
- If the ball goes out of bounds, the attacker restarts from the starting position.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the defender applying what they practiced — staying low, goal-side, and patient — or reverting to chasing and lunging?
- Is the defender making clean challenges — or fouling by using their body or arms illegally?
- Is the attacker using what they've learned offensively — feints, direction changes, speed variation — or just running straight at the defender?
- Is the defender recognizing when to hold their ground vs. when to step in and win the ball?
- When the ball is won, does the defender transition quickly — or stop and celebrate?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the goal — attacker just tries to dribble past the end line, defender tries to stop them.
 - Give the attacker a head start of 2–3 steps so they aren't stopped immediately — keeps the drill moving.
 - Pause and coach in real time: 'Defender — stay in front! Don't reach in yet.'
 - Emphasize that no touching the other person is allowed — reinforce safe play from the start.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use the small cone goal so there is a clear objective for both players.
 - After each round, give one piece of feedback to each player: one thing the attacker did well, one thing the defender did well.
 - Introduce the vocabulary: 'contain' — the defender's first job is to contain, not steal.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Allow the defender to attempt a slide tackle or standing tackle if they see the opportunity — with the rule that mistimed tackles are called as fouls.
 - Run a 'best of 5' format: 5 attacks, 5 defends, track who scores.
 - Debrief as a group: 'What made the attacker hardest to defend? What made the defender hardest to beat?'

Phrases to Use

- "Defender — contain first. Don't go for the ball until you're sure."
- "Stay goal-side. If they get past you, they have a clear shot."
- "No pushing, no grabbing — clean defense only."
- "Attacker — use what you know. Feint, change pace, change direction."
- "Win the ball, then go. Don't stop after a tackle."
- "Foul or clean? Let's talk about what just happened."

Skill Drill: Drop & Shoot

Skill Focus

Shooting off a served ball | First-touch finishing on the volley |
Composure and balance when striking a dropping ball

1 — Setup

- Set up 2–4 lines of students just outside the penalty area — each line angled slightly toward the goal.
- Place a goal at the end of the field (use cones if needed). Add a goalkeeper for 5th–6th groups.
- The coach (or a designated feeder) stands to the side of each line with a supply of balls.
- Each student in line will approach, receive a tossed ball, and shoot.

2 — What They'll Do

- The first student in line jogs toward the goal and calls 'Ready!'
- The coach tosses (underhand) the ball gently into the air slightly ahead of the student — so the ball drops in front of them as they arrive.
- The student lets the ball drop and strikes it on the first bounce — aiming for the goal.
- The student retrieves the ball, passes it back to the feeder, and returns to the back of the line.
- Coaching note: the toss height and placement is crucial — it should drop just ahead of the student's striking foot, not behind them or too far ahead.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student timing their run to arrive as the ball drops — or arriving too early (ball still in air) or too late (ball bounced twice)?
- Is the student striking through the ball cleanly — or making weak contact because they're off-balance or mis-timed?
- Is the student using the instep (laces) for power — or toe-poking at a dropping ball?
- Is the student's non-kicking foot planted next to the ball at contact — or kicking with a straight-leg stance?
- Is the student looking at the ball through contact — or lifting their head early to see if it goes in?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Lower the toss significantly — the ball should barely leave the ground before the student strikes it.
 - Allow the ball to bounce once before the student kicks it — remove the timing pressure of a dropping ball.
 - Focus only on making contact with the laces — don't require power or accuracy yet.
 - Coach can stand very close and toss gently to make the drill feel safe and achievable.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use a standard toss height — knee-to-waist height drop point.
 - Have students call 'Ready!' before approaching so the coach times the toss well.
 - Coach the laces strike: 'Foot pointed down, laces hitting the ball — like you're squishing it into the ground.'
 - Allow a second attempt if the first toss is mistimed — don't penalize poor tosses.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a goalkeeper to create real pressure on the shot.
 - Vary toss height and angle — sometimes higher, sometimes lower, sometimes slightly to the left or right — to challenge adaptability.
 - Require the student to call their target before the toss: 'Low left!' — holds them accountable for placement.
 - Add a time challenge: a set number of goals in 60 seconds across the full group.

Phrases to Use

- "Time your run — you want to arrive just as the ball drops."
- "Eyes on the ball all the way through contact. Don't peek at the goal early."
- "Laces through the ball — foot pointed down, strike through the center."
- "Plant foot next to the ball. If your plant foot is wrong, the shot is wrong."
- "Call Ready! so I know when to toss."
- "Don't blast it — place it. Pick a corner."

Skill Drill: Breakaway 1v0

Skill Focus

Finishing composure | Decision-making — when to shoot vs. keep dribbling | Approach and touch into shooting position

1 — Setup

- Set up 2–3 lines at the midfield line or top of the penalty area — one ball per student.
- Place a goal at the far end (use cones if no goal is available).
- Add a rotating goalkeeper for 4th–6th groups.
- Leave the field between the starting line and the goal completely clear — no defenders, no obstacles.

2 — What They'll Do

- On the coach's signal, the first player in each line pushes the ball forward and dribbles at full pace toward goal — simulating a breakaway.
- The student decides when to shoot based on their own judgment — there is no prescribed shooting spot.
- After shooting, the student retrieves the ball and joins the back of the line.
- Coach prompts a brief self-reflection after each attempt: 'Did you shoot at the right moment? Too early? Too late?'
- Key teaching point: a breakaway is about composure — slowing down slightly near the goal, setting the ball, and picking a spot rather than blasting from too far.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student shooting too early (far from goal, rushed, off-balance) or too late (too close, goalkeeper saves easily, angle is gone)?
- Is the student's final touch before shooting setting the ball into a good striking position — or do they shoot off a poor touch?
- Is the student staying composed near goal — or speeding up, panicking, and losing control?
- With a goalkeeper present, is the student reading the keeper's position and placing the shot — or just blasting regardless?
- Is the student following up after a miss — or stopping and watching?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Start all students just outside the penalty area — the full midfield run is too long and results in wild shots.
 - Remove the goalkeeper entirely so every run ends with a goal — builds confidence.
 - Focus on the final touch before shooting: 'Take one more touch to get the ball in front of you, then kick.'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Start from midfield for a real breakaway feel.
 - Introduce the goalkeeper for a portion of the session — not all of it.
 - Coach the deceleration: 'Don't speed up near goal — slow down, get your touch, pick your spot.'
 - After each attempt, ask one question: 'Did you shoot at the right time? What would you change?'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use a full goalkeeper who comes off their line to pressure the shooter — simulates a real breakaway.
 - Challenge: can the student score by going around the keeper (dribble past) instead of shooting?
 - Run it as a competition: how many goals out of 5 breakaways?
 - Introduce the concept of a chip shot — lift the ball over an onrushing keeper.

Phrases to Use

- "Breakaway — stay composed. This is your moment."
- "Don't speed up near goal. Slow down, set your touch, pick a spot."
- "One more touch to position the ball, then shoot."
- "Keeper coming out? Chip it or go wide — don't let them take the angle."
- "Too early! You were still 25 yards out. Get closer."
- "Follow your shot. If it bounces back, you're right there."



Games - Soccer

Soccer Games

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Game: Single Cone Soccer (1st–6th)

 **Reference Video:** Single Cone Soccer — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6hGBQhx41ag>

Skill Focus

1v1 attacking and defending | Dribbling under pressure | Offensive decision-making

1 — Setup

- Place 4–6 cones in a straight line, evenly spaced across the field or blacktop.
- Split students into groups of 4–5 and have them line up behind each cone.
- The first two players from each group step out to play — one on offense, one on defense.
- Set a timer for 20 seconds per round.

2 — How to Play

- The offensive player tries to hit the cone with the ball by dribbling and shooting past the defender.
- The defensive player tries to prevent the cone from being hit.
- The first player to hit the cone wins the round — or play until the 20-second timer ends.
- At the end of each round: the offense player rotates to defense, and the defense player moves to the back of the next line.
- Defensive positioning cue: arms in an 'L' shape, kick the ball away from the cone.
- Offensive positioning cue: shuffle and dribble to change directions and create openings.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the offensive player using body feints or direction changes to beat the defender — or just dribbling straight at them?
- Is the defender holding their 'L' arm shape and staying between the ball and the cone?
- Is the defender reacting to the ball or to the offensive player's movements?
- Is the offensive player maintaining control under pressure, or losing the ball due to rushing?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow the offensive player more space by starting them further from the cone — reduce the pressure from the defender.
 - Remove the 20-second timer and let each round play out naturally.
 - Coach the defensive stance before the round starts — demonstrate the 'L' shape arms.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the 20-second timer to add urgency.
 - Remind offensive players to use a change of direction — not just speed.
 - Prompt defenders to stay low and on their toes, not flat-footed.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Challenge offensive players to use at least one body feint before shooting.
 - Shorten the round to 15 seconds to increase pressure.
 - Ask defenders: 'Are you reacting to the ball or to the player's body?' — introduce reading fakes.

Phrases to Use

- "Offense — change direction! Don't just run straight at the defender."
- "Defense — arms in an L, stay between the ball and the cone."
- "Stay low — both of you. Athletic position!"
- "Offense — use your body to fake, then go the other way."
- "Defense — watch the ball, not the player's eyes."

Game: Soccer Ball Tic-Tac-Toe

 **Reference Video:** Soccer Ball Tic-Tac-Toe - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K0lqS7B5Y>

Skill Focus

Kicking accuracy and aim | Strategic thinking | Sportsmanship and turn-taking

1 — Setup

- Arrange 9 hula hoops in a 3x3 grid on the grass — like a tic-tac-toe board.
- Set up two lines of players behind cones on opposite sides of the grid.
- Each team has a set of colored beanbags to mark their claimed squares.
- Teams should be able to clearly see all 9 hoops from their starting line.

2 — How to Play

- Teams alternate turns — one player at a time steps up and kicks the ball toward the grid.
- If the ball lands and stays inside a hula hoop, the player places their team's colored beanbag in that hoop and returns to the back of the line.
- If the ball misses or rolls out, the player retrieves the ball, walks it back, and goes to the back of the line — no beanbag is placed.
- The first team to get three beanbags in a row — horizontally, vertically, or diagonally — wins.
- If all 9 hoops are claimed with no winner, the round is a tie.
- After each game, the team at the orange cones rotates to a new field to face a new opponent.
- **Pro-Tip:** Use 2-3 3x3 grids and rotate teams of students – Break students into equal teams, they each take turns kicking a ball (1 at a time), each team rotates after each round. Students not playing cheer for teams that are.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players aiming deliberately at a specific hoop, or just kicking in the general direction of the grid?
- Are players thinking strategically — kicking to block the opponent or to set up their own three-in-a-row?
- Are students waiting patiently for their turn and respecting the rotation?
- Are students using the inside of their foot for accuracy, or toe-kicking?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Widen the hula hoops or move the kicking line closer to make it easier to land in a hoop.
 - Allow students to roll or throw the ball instead of kicking if needed.
 - Skip the beanbag strategy element — just celebrate landing in any hoop.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Encourage students to call their target hoop before kicking: 'I'm going for the middle!'
 - Start introducing the blocking concept: 'Look at where they have two — can you block them?'
 - Players may use any part of the foot — don't restrict technique yet.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Require students to name their target square before kicking.
 - Emphasize blocking strategy: 'If they have two in a row, your priority is to block, not score.'
 - Use the inside of the foot only — reinforce accuracy over power.

Phrases to Use

- "Pick your square before you kick. Where are you aiming?"
- "Look at the board — where do you need to go to block them?"
- "Use the inside of your foot — toe kicks won't be accurate enough."
- "Good strategy! You blocked their three-in-a-row."
- "Even if you miss, you're learning how much power to use."

Game: Center Pin

 **Reference Video:** Center Pin — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dPrQuADu-s>

Skill Focus

Kicking technique and finesse | Accuracy and aim | Score management and mental math

1 — Setup

- Place a hula hoop in the center of the playing area with a bowling pin standing upright inside it.
- Two teams line up on opposite sides of the hula hoop — equal distance from the pin.
- Each team needs a ball to kick from their side.
- Display or verbally track each team's score throughout the game.

2 — How to Play

- Teams alternate turns — one player at a time steps up and kicks the ball toward the center pin.
- Players step with their opposite foot when kicking (plant the non-kicking foot next to the ball).
- Scoring is as follows:
 - Pin knocked over AND ball stays inside the hoop = 3 points.
 - Pin knocked over AND ball rolls out of the hoop = 2 points.
 - Ball stays inside the hoop but pin stays standing = 1 point.
- The first team to reach exactly 13 points wins.
- If a team goes over 13, they drop back to 10 and continue from there.
- The odd target of 13 means teams cannot win with only 2-point plays — at least one 1 or 3-point play is required to finish.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student planting their non-kicking foot next to the ball, or kicking off-balance?
- Are students kicking with finesse and control — or just hammering the ball as hard as possible?
- Are students (especially older grades) thinking about what score they need and adjusting their strategy?
- Are teams keeping accurate track of their own score?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Simplify the scoring: knocking the pin over = 1 point, regardless of where the ball goes.
 - Move teams closer to the hula hoop to make the pin easier to hit.
 - Let staff keep score so students can focus on kicking.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use the full 3-tier scoring system.
 - Have students keep their own team's score — builds number sense.
 - Coach the plant foot before rounds begin: 'Step next to the ball with your left foot, then kick with your right.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Emphasize the strategic element: 'You're at 12 — what do you need? Can you get exactly 1 point?'
 - Require teams to huddle and decide on a strategy before their player kicks.
 - Move teams further from the pin to increase difficulty.

Phrases to Use

- "Plant foot next to the ball before you kick — don't reach for it."
- "Aim for the base of the pin, not the top."
- "You're at 11 — do you want 2 or 3 points? Think before you kick!"
- "Soft kick for 1 point, harder for 2 or 3 — choose your power."
- "Nice finesse! That's exactly what this game is about."

Game: Soccer Golf

 **Reference Video: Soccer Golf** — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Y0B-feDL82c>

Skill Focus

Kicking accuracy and touch | Power vs. finesse decision-making |
Patience and sportsmanship

1 — Setup

- Place a hula hoop on the grass as the target hole ('the pin').
- Set up a starting cone at a set distance away from the hoop — adjust distance based on age and skill.
- Students work in pairs — one ball per pair.
- Optional: set up multiple 'holes' around the field using different hula hoops for a full course.

2 — How to Play

- Partners take turns trying to get the ball into or as close to the hula hoop as possible.
- Players may kick or throw the ball — whichever they prefer.
- Each kick or throw counts as one stroke.
- Players continue taking turns until the ball lands in or right next to the hoop.
- Fewest total strokes to reach the hoop wins — just like real golf.
- As players get closer to the hoop, encourage them to use lighter, more controlled touches instead of full kicks.
- If running a multi-hole course, partners add up their total strokes across all holes — lowest score wins.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students adjusting their power based on distance — strong kick from far away, soft touch up close?
- Are students thinking about angle and direction, or just kicking straight at the hoop every time?
- Are partners taking turns fairly and keeping accurate stroke counts?
- As students get close to the hoop, are they switching to finesse — or still hammering the ball past it?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Move the starting cone closer to the hoop to keep stroke counts low and success rates high.
 - Allow throwing instead of kicking — younger students often have more accuracy with their hands.
 - Don't count strokes competitively — just celebrate getting the ball in the hoop.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce the stroke-counting element — keep it simple and fun.
 - Prompt the power-vs-finesse concept: 'You're close now — use a tap, not a kick.'
 - Set up 2–3 holes so pairs move around the field.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Run a full multi-hole course (4–6 holes) with varied distances and angles.
 - Require kicking only — no throwing.
 - Add a par score for each hole and challenge students to beat it.
 - Discuss real golf strategy: 'Why would you chip instead of drive near the hole?'

Phrases to Use

- "How far are you? Use more power from far away, less when you're close."
- "Tap it — don't kick it. You're right next to the hoop!"
- "Think about the angle. Are you kicking straight at it, or setting up a better next shot?"
- "Count your strokes honestly — sportsmanship matters even in golf."
- "Nice soft touch! That's exactly what you want near the hole."

Game: Goalie (Gaga) Ball

 **Reference Video:** Goalie Ball — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5kq5QwLpd44>

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy and ground ball control | Defensive positioning and awareness | Self-officiation and sportsmanship

1 — Setup

- Mark out a large square grid on the grass using cones.
- Each of the 8 players is assigned their own two-cone goal along the perimeter.
- Goals are evenly distributed around the grid — each goal line is marked with two cones set about 3–4 feet apart.
- Keep a waiting line outside the grid — players who are scored on rotate out and new players rotate in.

2 — How to Play

- One player starts by gently passing the ball with their foot into the center of the grid to begin play.
- All players use the inside of their foot to pass and shoot — trying to score through another player's two-cone goal.
- A goal is scored when the ball rolls cleanly through another player's goal line (between their two cones).
- Goals only count if the ball is rolling along the ground — any ball that rises above knee height does not count.
- If the ball rolls through the center of the grid without hitting a goal, it is a redo and play restarts.
- When a player is scored on, they rotate out and go to the back of the waiting line.
- The next person in the waiting line enters and also serves as the referee for their round — they make the final call on disputed plays.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players using the inside of the foot for accuracy, or blasting the ball with their laces?
- Are players positioning themselves to defend their own goal while staying involved offensively?
- Is the ball staying on the ground? Are students correcting themselves after lofted shots?

- Are players self-officiating honestly — calling their own goals scored on — or disputing every call?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Reduce to 4–5 players at a time so the grid is less chaotic.
 - Make the goals wider (4–5 feet) so scoring happens more frequently.
 - Remove the knee-height rule — let any ball count to keep the game moving.
 - Coach can referee all calls to reduce conflict.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the ground-ball-only rule — remind students immediately when the ball goes up.
 - Assign the referee role to the waiting player as described.
 - Encourage players to defend their own goal without camping directly in front of it.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Shrink the grid slightly to reduce space and increase competition.
 - Hold students strictly to the inside-of-foot rule — correct laces shots in real time.
 - Discuss defensive positioning: 'Where should you stand to protect your goal and still attack?'

Phrases to Use

- "Inside of the foot — you need accuracy, not power."
- "Keep the ball on the ground! If it goes above the knee, it doesn't count."
- "Protect your goal — but don't just stand in front of it. Stay involved!"
- "Referee — what's your call? Own it."
- "Nice pass! That was controlled and accurate."

Game: Corner Ball

Skill Focus

Decision-making under pressure | Shooting accuracy |
Multi-directional defending | Listening and quick reaction

1 — Setup

- Mark out a large square playing area on the grass using cones.
- Place a 2-cone goal in each corner of the area — one goal per team, 4 goals total.
- Divide students into 4 teams, one team assigned to defend each corner goal.
- Each player on every team is assigned a number.
- Place one ball in the center of the field to start.

2 — How to Play

- The coach calls out a number — the player from each team with that number runs onto the field.
- The 4 active players compete to get the ball and score on any goal that is not their own.
- If a goal is scored, every team except the one that was scored on receives a point.
- After the point, the ball is reset to center and the coach calls the next number.
- The coach can call 1 number or 2–3 numbers simultaneously to control the pace and action.
- Avoid calling all numbers at once to prevent overcrowding.
- Each round ends when every number has been called at least once.
- Teams track their own points throughout the round.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are active players scanning the field to find the nearest undefended goal — or just chasing the ball randomly?
- Is the active player making quick decisions after getting the ball, or holding it too long?
- Are bench players listening closely for their number — or missing their call?
- Are players tracking all 3 opponent goals or only focusing on one direction?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Pair younger or less confident players with a buddy number — call both at once so they go out together.
 - Reduce to 2 teams and 2 goals to simplify the multi-directional element.
 - Make the goals wider and the playing area smaller.
 - Call numbers slowly with a longer reset between calls.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use the full 4-team setup.
 - Call 1–2 numbers at a time.
 - Prompt players before their number might come up: 'Eyes open — be ready!'
 - Rotate number assignments between rounds to create new matchups.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Call 2–3 numbers at once for fast, dynamic play.
 - Shrink the field slightly to increase pressure.
 - Challenge players: 'When you get the ball, how quickly can you find the open goal?'
 - Add a rule: players must dribble into the scoring zone before shooting — no long-range goals.

Phrases to Use

- "When you get the ball — look up! Which goal has no one in front of it?"
- "Listen for your number. Stay ready at all times."
- "Don't just chase — think about where you want to go before you get the ball."
- "If someone scores on your goal, your team loses a point. Hustle back!"
- "Two numbers — work together out there!"

Game: Sharks & Minnows Dribble

Skill Focus

Dribbling under pressure | Ball shielding | Spatial awareness

1 — Setup

- Define a boundary using cones — a large rectangle or circle works well. Adjust size based on group size: bigger group, bigger boundary.
- Every student (minnows) has a soccer ball and starts inside the boundary.
- Select 2–3 students as sharks — they do not have a ball.
- Identify sharks with pinnies or colored vests if available.

2 — How to Play

- All minnows dribble freely within the boundary while protecting their ball from the sharks.
- Sharks try to kick minnows' balls out of the boundary — no body contact allowed.
- If a minnow's ball is kicked out of bounds, or if they lose control and it rolls out, they are eliminated.
- Eliminated players sit on the sideline until the next round.
- The last minnow still dribbling inside the boundary wins the round.
- Rotate shark roles between every round so all students get a turn.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are minnows using their body to shield the ball — keeping themselves between the shark and the ball?
- Are students using the whole boundary, or bunching together and making things harder for themselves?
- Are students keeping their head up to track the sharks, or staring at the ball?
- Are sharks being tactical — working together, cutting off space — or just individually chasing the nearest ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use a larger boundary so students have more space and less immediate pressure.
 - Use only 1 shark to keep things manageable.
 - Allow eliminated students to rejoin after completing 5 jumping jacks to keep everyone active.
 - Focus on the fun of the chase rather than strict elimination rules.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use 2 sharks for groups of 12 or more.
 - Shrink the boundary by one cone on each side every 30 seconds to increase pressure.
 - Remind minnows to shield with their body — not to hold off sharks with their hands.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use 2–3 sharks and start with a tighter boundary.
 - Require students to use only their non-dominant foot for a full round.
 - Add a rule: minnows cannot stop moving for more than 2 seconds — they must keep dribbling.
 - Challenge: can any minnow survive a full 60 seconds with 3 sharks?

Phrases to Use

- "Shield the ball — put your body between the shark and the ball!"
- "Use the whole field! Spread out — don't bunch together."
- "Head up — where are the sharks right now?"
- "Sharks — work together. One cuts off the space, the other goes for the ball."
- "Small touches — keep the ball close so it's harder to knock away."

Game: Rondo

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy and speed | First touch under pressure | Movement off the ball | Decision-making in tight spaces

1 — Setup

- Divide students into groups of 5–7.
- Each group has 1 soccer ball.
- Mark a small grid for each group using 4 cones — roughly 8x8 to 10x10 feet. Adjust size based on skill.
- Within each group, 1–2 players start as defenders inside the grid. The remaining players are passers positioned around the outside edges.

2 — How to Play

- Passers on the outside work together to keep the ball away from the defenders inside the grid.
- Passers may move along their side of the grid but cannot enter the grid.
- Defenders stay inside the grid and try to intercept or deflect passes.
- If a defender wins the ball or the ball goes out of play, the passer who made the bad pass swaps in as the new defender.
- Groups count consecutive successful passes — the goal is 10 in a row without a turnover.
- After a successful set of 10, rotate defenders so everyone takes a turn in the middle.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are passers moving to create better angles before the ball arrives — or standing flat-footed?
- Is the first touch controlling the ball close and setting up the next pass — or bouncing away?
- Are players making quick decisions, or holding the ball until the defender closes them down?
- Are defenders staying active — pressuring the ball and blocking passing lanes — or standing in the center watching?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Start without a defender — just practice passing around the outside of the grid.
 - Use a larger grid so passes are shorter and easier to complete.
 - Allow students to stop the ball before passing — no rushed passes required.
 - Focus on using the inside of the foot, not the toe.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use 1 defender once the group can complete 5 passes without one.
 - Count passes aloud as a group — build toward 10.
 - Encourage passers to talk: 'Here!' or 'Man on!' to communicate.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use 2 defenders and a slightly larger group (6–7 passers).
 - Limit to 2-touch: one touch to receive, one to pass — no extra touches.
 - Add a rule: the same passer cannot receive two passes in a row — ball must move.
 - Shrink the grid to 7x7 feet to reduce passing time and space.

Phrases to Use

- "Move before the ball gets to you — create an angle!"
- "Soft first touch — keep it close."
- "Quick pass! Don't hold it — the defender is closing."
- "Defender — block a passing lane, don't just stand in the middle."
- "Talk to each other! 'Here!' 'Turn!' 'Man on!'"

Game: 4-Goal Scrimmage

Skill Focus

Tactical decision-making | Multi-directional attacking and defending | Teamwork and communication

1 — Setup

- Mark a large rectangular playing area using cones.
- Create 4 small goals (2 cones each, about 4 feet wide) — place 2 goals on each end line, spread apart.
- Divide students into 2 teams. Each team defends the 2 goals on their end line and attacks the 2 goals on the opponent's end line.
- Use pinnies or colored vests to differentiate teams.
- Start with the ball at the center of the field.

2 — How to Play

- Normal soccer rules apply — teams pass and dribble to advance toward the opponent's goals.
- A goal is scored by kicking the ball through either of the opponent's two small goals along the ground.
- Because there are 2 goals to attack and 2 to defend, players must constantly make decisions about which goal to target and which to protect.
- After a goal is scored, the team that was scored on restarts from their own end.
- No goalkeepers — all players are field players.
- Play rounds of 5–7 minutes, then rotate teams or adjust teams for balance.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players scanning the field to find the less-defended goal — or always attacking the same side?
- Is the team spreading out to cover both of their own goals defensively, or leaving one open?
- Are teams communicating — calling for the ball, directing teammates to cover a goal?
- Are players making quick decisions after winning the ball, or holding it too long?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use wider goals so scoring is more accessible.
 - Reduce team size to 3v3 so each player is more involved.
 - Coach can pause play briefly to point out an open goal: 'Look — that goal is open! Who can get there?'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use 4v4 or 5v5 teams.
 - Pause play once or twice to discuss positioning: 'Where are your two goals? Is anyone covering the left one?'
 - Encourage students to communicate which goal they are covering on defense.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use 5v5 or 6v6.
 - Add a condition: teams must complete 3 passes before they are allowed to shoot.
 - Introduce basic formations: 'Two players always stay back to protect our goals.'
 - After the game, debrief: 'Which goal did they score through most? Why? What could you have done differently?'

Phrases to Use

- "Look up — which goal is less defended? Go there!"
- "Defense — someone needs to cover the left goal. Who's got it?"
- "Spread out! If you all cluster in the middle, you're leaving a goal wide open."
- "Talk to each other — this game is won by communication."
- "Quick decision after you win the ball — don't hold it too long."

Game: Dribble Knockout

Skill Focus

Ball shielding and protection | Dribbling under pressure | Spatial awareness and positioning

1 — Setup

- Mark a large circle or square using cones — size depends on group. Roughly 20x20 feet for 10–12 players.
- Every student has a soccer ball and starts inside the boundary.
- No teams — every player is for themselves.
- Have students spread out to fill the boundary before the game begins.

2 — How to Play

- On the coach's signal, all players simultaneously dribble within the boundary while trying to kick other players' balls out.
- Players protect their own ball while trying to knock opponents' balls outside the cones.
- If your ball is kicked outside the boundary — or if you lose control and it rolls out — you are eliminated.
- Eliminated players step outside the boundary and watch from the sideline.
- The last player with a ball inside the boundary wins the round.
- Keep rounds short (60–90 seconds) and rotate back in quickly to minimize waiting.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students shielding the ball — using their body as a barrier — or leaving it exposed?
- Are students using the full space available, or retreating into a corner?
- Are students using controlled touches to stay in bounds, or making big kicks that send their own ball out?
- Are students trying to go on offense (knock others out) or just playing defensive the entire time?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use a larger boundary so there is less immediate contact pressure - Can they move with the ball while staying in bounds?
 - Allow students who are eliminated to re-enter after 10 seconds to keep everyone active.
 - Focus on the concept of moving with ball control (avoid running into other players and staying in bounds)
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Standard rules — full elimination.
 - Shrink the boundary by one cone per side after 30 seconds to increase pressure.
 - Remind students: offense wins games — don't just protect, go knock others out too.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Start with a tighter boundary.
 - Require non-dominant foot only for a full round.
 - **Add a rule:** players must complete a full loop around the boundary before they can start knocking out opponents — forces movement.
 - Run a 'Champions' round: last 3 survivors from each round play each other.

Phrases to Use

- "Shield it! Body between the ball and the opponent."
- "Stay on the move — standing still makes you an easy target."
- "Don't just defend — go attack someone else's ball!"
- "Use the whole space. If you retreat to a corner, you're trapped."
- "Small touches — a big kick might send your own ball out!"

Game: Freeze Tag Dribble

Skill Focus

Dribbling while moving through space | Teamwork and awareness of teammates | Ball control at various speeds

1 — Setup

- Define a boundary using cones — half field or a large rectangle. Adjust size based on group.
- Every student has a soccer ball and starts spread out inside the boundary - rotate in groups if limited on space or equipment.
- Select 2–3 students as taggers — they do not have a ball.
- Identify taggers with pinnies or a colored vest.

2 — How to Play

- All students with a ball dribble freely within the boundary while avoiding the taggers.
- Taggers try to tag dribblers by touching them with their hand — no kicking balls or contact with the ball.
- When a dribbler is tagged, they freeze in place with one foot on top of their ball.
- A frozen player can be unfrozen when a teammate dribbles a full circle around them without stopping.
- If a dribbler's ball rolls outside the boundary, they are automatically frozen.
- Taggers rotate after each round. Play rounds of 60–90 seconds.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are dribblers maintaining control while scanning for both taggers and frozen teammates?
- Are students actively looking to unfreeze teammates — or only focused on saving themselves?
- Is the dribble staying close and controlled, or going loose when students move quickly?
- Are taggers being strategic — cornering players or guarding frozen players to stop rescues?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use only 1 tagger to reduce pressure.
 - **Simplify the unfreeze:** a teammate just needs to tap the frozen player's shoulder (no full dribble circle required).
 - Allow students to walk their dribble instead of jogging.
 - Use a larger boundary so there is more space to avoid being tagged.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use 2 taggers for groups of 15+.
 - Enforce the full dribble-circle unfreeze — no shortcuts.
 - Prompt awareness: 'Look around — who is frozen? Can you get to them?'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use 2–3 taggers and a tighter boundary.
 - Add a challenge: taggers can also guard frozen players to prevent unfreezing — makes rescues harder.
 - Require non-dominant foot dribbling for a full round.
 - Challenge: can the team keep everyone unfrozen for a full 90 seconds?

Phrases to Use

- "You have 2 jobs - Don't get tagged and unfreeze your teammates"
- "Help your teammates! Go unfreeze someone — that's how your team stays alive."
- "Taggers — guard the frozen players! Make it hard to rescue them."
- "Control your dribble when you do the unfreeze circle — don't lose the ball."
- "If your ball rolls out, you're frozen automatically. Keep it in bounds!"

Game: Scoring Derby

Skill Focus

Shooting accuracy and power selection | Shot approach and technique | Competitive shooting under time pressure

1 — Setup

- Set up a goal at one end of the field (or use cones to create a goal).
- Use cones to mark 3 shooting zones in front of the goal:
- Zone 1 (closest) — inside the penalty area = 1 point.
- Zone 2 (middle) — just outside the penalty area = 2 points.
- Zone 3 (furthest) — near the top of the box or beyond = 3 points.
- Divide students into 2 teams. Each team lines up on opposite sides of the goal.
- Add a goalkeeper (rotating student) for added challenge — optional.

2 — How to Play

- Teams alternate sending one shooter at a time to take a shot from any zone they choose.
- The shooter earns points based on which zone they shoot from — only if the shot goes in.
- A miss from any zone earns 0 points.
- After each shot, the shooter retrieves the ball and returns to their team's line.
- Play for 3 minutes, then count total points. The team with the most points wins the round.
- Rotate the goalkeeper role every minute if using one.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students choosing shooting zones based on their skill level — or always going for the high-value zone regardless of accuracy?
- Is the approach controlled — plant foot next to the ball, striking through the center?
- Are students adjusting their technique based on the distance they are shooting from?
- Are students making smart decisions, or taking low-percentage shots from far out every time?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use only Zone 1 (inside the box) — no point differential needed.
 - Use a wider goal or remove the goalkeeper entirely.
 - Focus on the plant foot and striking technique rather than accuracy targets.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use all 3 zones.
 - Discuss strategy before the game: 'Is it smarter to get 1 point you know you can score, or risk a 3-pointer you might miss?'
 - Rotate the goalkeeper every 60 seconds.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a 4th zone beyond the full penalty area worth 4 points for the boldest shooters.
 - Require students to call their zone before approaching the ball.
 - Add a time limit: each shooter has 5 seconds to shoot once they step into the zone.
 - Introduce the concept of power vs. finesse: 'From Zone 1, do you need power or placement?'

Phrases to Use

- "Pick a zone you can actually score from — don't just go for 3 every time."
- "Plant foot next to the ball. That's the key to a clean shot."
- "Power from far, placement from close. Adjust your shot."
- "Call your zone before you step up — commit to it."
- "Nice placement! You didn't blast it — you picked your spot."

Game: Scrimmage (Modified)

Skill Focus

Applying skills in a live game context | Adaptability | Teamwork and communication

1 — Setup

- Set up a standard small-sided field with 2 goals (cone goals work fine).
- Divide students into 2 equal teams using pinnies.
- Choose a condition to apply for the first round (see condition examples below).
- Write the condition on a whiteboard or announce it clearly before each round starts.

2 — How to Play

- Teams play a normal small-sided scrimmage with one added condition that changes how the game is played.
- The condition stays in effect for the entire round (5–7 minutes), then the coach announces a new condition for the next round.
- Suggested conditions:
 - **Left/right/off foot only** — all touches and passes must use the left (non-dominant) foot.
 - **3-touch max** — players may take no more than 3 touches before passing or shooting.
 - **Must pass before shooting** — a team cannot shoot until they have completed at least 1 pass in that possession.
 - **Silence** — no talking allowed. Teams must communicate using only hand signals and eye contact.
 - **Score by position** — a goal only counts if it is scored by a designated player (e.g., only the player wearing a specific pinnie can score).
- After a goal, the scoring team's next possession must start from their own half.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students adapting to the condition, or reverting to their default habits under pressure?
- When the condition limits something (e.g., left foot only), are students slowing down and being intentional — or ignoring the rule?
- Are teams communicating to help each other follow the condition?
- Are students understanding why each condition helps them in a real game?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use simple conditions only: 'Must pass to a teammate before shooting' or 'Walk only — no running.'
 - Coach acts as a gentle referee to help students remember the condition.
 - Keep rounds to 3–4 minutes so the condition doesn't feel too restrictive for long.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use conditions like 'left foot only,' '3-touch max,' or 'must pass before shooting.'
 - Briefly explain why the condition helps: '3-touch max forces you to think ahead — just like in a real game.'
 - Pause play once if teams are struggling with the condition to reset and re-explain.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use more challenging conditions: silence, headers only, or restrict who can score.
 - Let students vote on the condition for the next round — increases buy-in.
 - After each round, ask: 'How did the condition change the way you played? Was it harder or easier to score?'

Phrases to Use

- "Remember the condition — what is it this round? Say it out loud."
- "If you forget the rule, your team loses possession. Help each other remember."
- "This condition is hard because it makes you play differently. That's the point."
- "Left foot feels weird — that's because you need to practice it more. Keep going."
- "Silence round — no talking! Use your eyes and your hands to communicate."

Game: Numbers Breakaway

Skill Focus

1v1, 2v1, and 2v2 attacking and defending | Quick reaction and transition | Shooting and finishing under pressure

1 — Setup

- Set up a full or half field with a goal at each end (or single goal for younger groups).
- Divide students into 2 equal teams. Teams line up on opposite sidelines, each player assigned a number.
- Place 1–2 balls in the center of the field.
- Coach stands at the center with a clear view of both lines.

2 — How to Play

- The coach calls out one or more numbers — the player(s) from each team with that number sprint onto the field.
- Players compete to win the ball from the center and score on the opponent's goal.
- When 1 number is called: it is a 1v1 — one player from each team.
- When 2 numbers are called: it is a 2v2 — two players from each team.
- Calling 1 and 2 different numbers creates an uneven scenario: 1v2 attacking or defending situations.
- After a goal is scored or the ball goes out of play, active players return to their line and the coach calls the next number(s).
- Rotate which numbers are called to ensure all students play regularly.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- In 1v1 situations, is the attacker using a body feint or direction change — or just running straight at the defender?
- In 2v2 situations, is the player without the ball making a run to create space — or standing still?
- Are defending players jockeying and staying on their feet — or diving in and getting beaten?
- Are students reacting quickly to the number call and sprinting onto the field — or slow to start?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Call 2 numbers at a time so students are not isolated in a 1v1 — pairs feel less pressure.
 - Use a single goal so all action is focused in one direction.
 - Make the goal larger (wider cone spacing) to increase scoring.
 - Give students a moment after the call to identify their partner before sprinting.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Mix 1-number and 2-number calls.
 - Pause after a 1v1 round to coach the attacker: 'What could you have done to beat the defender?'
 - Encourage attackers to take the defender on rather than waiting for a better option.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Introduce uneven numbers: call '1 and 3' — player 1 attacks against both players 3 from each team (2v1 defending).
 - Require the attacking team to complete a pass before shooting in 2v2 situations.
 - Debrief after: 'In the 2v1, what did the defender do well? What made it hard for them?'

Phrases to Use

- "When your number is called — sprint! Every second counts."
- "Attacker: use a feint — don't just run at the defender."
- "Second player: make a run! Create space for your teammate."
- "Defender: stay on your feet. Don't dive in."
- "2v1 offense: move the ball quickly — the defender can't cover two people forever."

Game: World Cup

Skill Focus

Shooting and finishing | Defending and goalkeeping instincts | Competitive strategy

1 — Setup

- Set up a goal at one end (or two goals if space allows for a full-field version).
- Each student picks a country to represent — write them on a whiteboard or have them announce it.
- One student starts as a goalkeeper. All other students line up outside the penalty area.
- Use 1–2 soccer balls.

2 — How to Play

- The first player in line dribbles in and takes a shot on goal.
- If they score, they stay in the game and go to the back of the line.
- If the goalkeeper saves the shot, the shooter is eliminated and must give their country name to the goalkeeper.
- If the shot misses the goal entirely, the shooter is also eliminated and gives their country to the goalkeeper.
- The goalkeeper collects eliminated players' countries — they now represent all of those countries plus their own.
- **Rotate the goalkeeper role:** after every 3–4 saves, the goalkeeper joins the shooting line and a new goalkeeper is chosen.
- The last shooter remaining wins the World Cup.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are shooters picking a corner or aiming deliberately — or just blasting the ball at the middle?
- Is the goalkeeper reading the shooter's approach and positioning well — or just reacting after the shot?
- Are players waiting their turn and watching the game — or disengaged between turns?
- Are students showing sportsmanship when eliminated — or reacting negatively?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove the goalkeeper entirely or use a passive goalkeeper (stands still) so scoring is easier.
 - Allow students to take **2 shots** before being eliminated.
 - Move the shooting line closer to the goal.
 - Skip the country-collection element — just play for fun and rotate freely.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use a real rotating goalkeeper.
 - Allow 1 rebound attempt: if the keeper saves it, the shooter can shoot once more from where the ball lands.
 - Have students announce their country before they shoot — adds fun and personality.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Full rules as described including country collection.
 - Require students to call their shot: 'Low left corner!' before shooting — and hold them to it.
 - Add a shooting condition: must use non-dominant foot for a full round.
 - Let the student who has collected the most countries be announced as 'tournament leader' each round.

Phrases to Use

- "Pick your corner before you shoot — aim, don't just blast it."
- "Keeper: watch the plant foot — it tells you which side the shot is going."
- "Good save! Now you've got their country too — you're getting powerful."
- "If you get eliminated, cheer for your teammates — be a good sport."
- "Call your shot! Top right — let's see it!"

Game: Gate Dribble Race

Skill Focus

Dribbling agility and change of direction | Ball control at speed |
Competitive individual and team play

1 — Setup

- Scatter 8–12 gates across the field using pairs of cones — gates should be 3–4 feet wide and placed at varied angles.
- Every student has a soccer ball.
- Each gate is worth 1 point when dribbled through.
- Coach sets a timer for 60–90 seconds per round.

2 — How to Play

- On the coach's signal, all participating students dribble freely around the field and pass through as many gates as possible.
- A gate counts only when the player dribbles through it cleanly — ball and both feet pass between the cones.
- Players cannot use the same gate twice in a row — they must visit a different gate between repeats.
- Players count their own gates.
- When the timer ends, the coach asks: 'Who got 5? Who got 8? Who got 10+?'
- **Optional team format:** divide into teams and add up each team's gate count for a combined score.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students making efficient routes between gates — or wandering without a plan?
- Is the dribble staying controlled at speed — or does the ball get away when students try to move fast?
- Are students using both feet as they change direction through gates?
- Are students being honest with their own counts?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use wider gates (4–5 feet) so passing through is easier.
 - Reduce the number of gates to 5–6 so the course is less overwhelming.
 - Allow students to walk or jog
 - Remove the competitive counting element.
 - Increase/Decrease amount of time
 - Decrease number or distance between gates
 - Coach can point students toward the nearest gate: 'There's one right there — go!'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use 8–10 gates and enforce the 'no repeat' rule. (Can't go through a red gate twice in a row)
 - Have students count aloud as they go through each gate.
 - Pair students up: one dribbles, one counts — then switch.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use 10–12 gates and set a target: 'Can anyone hit 12 gates in 60 seconds?'
 - Require non-dominant foot only for one full round.
 - Add a team relay element: students take turns in 15-second sprints — combine team totals.
 - Tighten gate width to 2.5 feet for extra precision challenge.

Phrases to Use

- "Look ahead — pick your next gate before you finish the one you're in."
- "Control first, speed second. Don't let the ball get away from you."
- "Use both feet — don't always turn the same direction."
- "Plan your route — don't wander. You're leaving points on the field."
- "Nice change of direction! That's exactly what this drill is for."

Game: One-On-One

Skill Focus

Dribbling agility and change of direction | Ball control at speed |
Competitive individual play

1 — Setup

- Setup a grid of 4 cones using 2 colors – Designate 1 as the start cone.
- Use 2 cones of a different color and place them in between the two start cones (this will serve as the goal)
- Have 1-2 soccerballs ready
- Students line up in roughly equal teams behind each start cone
- **Safety Rule:** Students that are lined up should be standing away from where the ball will be traveling when students shoot the ball

2 — How to Play

- On the goaches signal, one player from each team will run (starting from their team's start cone) around their team's opposite cone.
- Once the first player rounds the cone, the coach will throw the soccer ball in a random place in the playing field.
- Each player will attempt to score the thrown soccer ball into the goal.
- Make or miss, both students participating, high five and say **Good Game**
- Once everyone on each team has had a chance to play, change up the order of each team so that they have a different person to go against.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are the students taking a wide turn around the second cone? Or taking a sharp turn?
- Are the students turning the corner and scanning for the ball?
- Are the students able to control their speed when approaching the ball?
- Do students defend by staying square to the goal? Or do they turn and create an opening?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use 2 soccer balls - allow both players to have an opportunity to score.
 - Send 1 student from each team at a time
 - Shorten the length each student has to run
 - Increase the width of the goal.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Increase the distance between start and rounding cone
 - Add a **Shot Clock** rule: Once the first student touches the ball, coach and non-participating students start counting down from **20**
- **5th–6th:**
 - Change position of rounding cone: Make the students run out at an angle (**not directly straight**) - making the turning more sharp
 - Add additional players: Coach calls out numbers (**instead of go**) – Coach calls out “**One!**” and the first player from each team goes. After 5 seconds – Coach then calls out “**Two!**” and the next person in line can participate to help their team score.

Phrases to Use

- “Stay close to the turning cone – try not to make a wide turn”
- “When you are defending, always keep your back to the goal”
- “Defend with bent arms! – We don’t push our opponent away we just keep them at a safe distance”
- “Control over speed – Use all the time you have and use it wisely”



Other Games

Other Games (Field / Blacktop / Indoor)

This section contains supplemental game activities for the Expanded Learning Program (ELP) Summer 2026, organized across three sub-tabs by setting. Each tab includes setup instructions, game rules, grade-band modifications, and focus areas to support coaches in running activities smoothly across different environments.

More games may be added

Field Games Large-group outdoor games designed for grass or open field spaces. Includes age-differentiated options:

- **Ultimate Kickball** (3rd–6th) – offense/defense kickball with base running
 - **Team Kickball** (4th–6th) – team-based kickball with running point totals
 - **Cleaning the House** – four-team game where players move balls into opponents' quadrants
 - **Ultimate Ball** – end zone passing game similar to ultimate frisbee
 - **Four-Way Capture the Flag** – multi-team territory and flag retrieval game
 - **Animal Rescue Run** (TK–2nd) – agility and movement activity with simple obstacles
 - **Sharks and Minnows** (TK–2nd) – classic end-line tag game with movement variations
 - **Zone Pass Challenge** – team passing game where players complete sequences through zones to score
-

Blacktop Games Wall and court-based games suited for paved outdoor spaces.

- **Floorball** – strike-and-score game played across a boundary line
 - **Two Square** (TK–2nd) & **Foursquare** (3rd–6th) – classic square bounce games
 - **Handball Progressions** (TK–2nd) & **Handball** (1st–6th) – wall-based striking and rotation games
 - **Two Touch** – wall handball variant with rotation when a player is out
 - **Treasure Protectors** – zone-based game where players steal from and defend their team's area
 - **Clean Your Yard** – teams continuously toss objects to the opposing side for the duration of a timed round
-

Indoor Games Low-equipment games designed for classroom or gym settings:

- **Cone Flip Relay** – team relay with cone flipping challenge
- **Head, Shoulders, Knees, Cone!** – reaction game where partners race to grab a cone
- **Rubber Band Cup Stack** (3rd–6th) – cooperative fine motor challenge using a shared rubber band
- **Crate Volleyball** – underhand striking game over a net or barrier
- **Four Corners** – movement and decision-making game using corner zones
- **Silent Ball** – quiet passing game where talking or dropping the ball results in elimination
- **Color Match Dash** – locomotor movement game where students race to match colored cones

Field Games

Field Games

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Game: Ultimate Kickball (3rd–6th)

 **Reference Video:** Ultimate Kickball — <https://youtu.be/ZX3H-jqkETw>

Skill Focus

Kicking fundamentals | Throwing accuracy | Base running and decision-making | Teamwork and communication

1 — Setup

- Set up a standard kickball diamond with bases at the four corners.
- Place a bowling pin upright on the pitching rubber at the center of the field.
- Divide students into two equal teams — offense and defense.
- One student from the defense team rolls the ball to the kicker from the pitching position.

2 — How to Play

- The pitcher rolls the ball to the kicker, who kicks it and immediately runs the bases.
- The defense fields the kicked ball and attempts to throw it at the bowling pin to record an out — they do NOT throw to bases.
- If a base runner is off a base when the pin is knocked down, they are out.
- If a base runner is on a base when the pin is knocked down, they are safe.
- Every player on offense kicks once per inning, then teams switch — offense becomes defense and vice versa.
- Play as many innings as time allows.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are kickers using a controlled approach and kicking through the ball — or just swinging and missing?
- Is the defense communicating — calling for the ball, identifying the best person to throw to the pin?
- Are base runners watching the ball and making smart decisions about when to run vs. hold?
- Is the throwing player aiming at the pin accurately, or throwing without a target?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - This game is designed for 3rd–6th. For younger students, play standard Team Kickball instead.
 - If including TK–2nd, use a stationary ball (placed on a cone) instead of a rolled pitch.
 - Remove the base-running element — focus only on kicking and fielding.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Walk through the pin rule before the game starts — it's different from standard kickball.
 - Allow 2–3 fielders to collaborate before deciding who throws at the pin.
 - Remind base runners: 'Watch the ball — run when the fielder is looking away from the pin.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Hold students to standard base-running rules — no coaching from the sideline mid-play.
 - Add a strategic layer: defense must decide in real time who has the best throwing angle to the pin.
 - After a few innings, ask: 'What base-running strategy did you use? When did you decide to run?'

Phrases to Use

- "Kicker — approach at an angle, kick through the ball, not under it."
- "Defense — who has the best throw to the pin? Communicate!"
- "Base runner — watch the fielder. Run when they're looking at the ball, not the pin."
- "Aim at the pin! Pick your target before you throw."
- "Every player kicks once — stay in order and be ready."

Game: Team Kickball (4th–6th)

 **Reference Video:** Team Kickball — <https://youtu.be/8jT45QiEydM>

Skill Focus

Kicking fundamentals | Base running | Teamwork and communication
| Passing and ball handling

1 — Setup

- Divide students into two teams — offense and defense.
- Set up a standard kickball diamond with bases at the four corners.
- Each player on offense kicks once per round — no outs are recorded.

2 — How to Play

- There are no outs in this game — every player on offense kicks once before teams switch.
- After kicking, the runner runs as many bases as possible while the defense retrieves and responds to the ball.
- Each base a runner touches is worth 1 point — teams keep a running total.
- The team with the most points at the end of all rounds wins.
- Version 1 — Stop Rule: After the ball is kicked, the defense lines up in a straight line behind the fielder and yells 'Stop!' — the runner freezes and scores points for whatever base they reached.
- Version 2 — Over-Under: The defense lines up behind the fielder and passes the ball over-under (over the head, under the legs, alternating) down the line until the last person yells 'Stop!' — the runner scores points based on whatever base they reached.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are kickers choosing a direction and kicking with intention — or just making contact and hoping for the best?
- In Version 1, is the defense sprinting to line up quickly — or casually jogging?
- In Version 2, is the over-under passing fast and controlled — or sloppy and slow?
- Are base runners pacing themselves strategically — sprinting hard knowing the defense is racing too?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce Version 1 first — it's simpler and faster to execute.
 - Once Version 1 is working well, introduce Version 2 and practice the over-under motion before playing.
 - Remind the defense: 'The faster you line up, the fewer points they score!'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Run both versions in separate rounds so students experience both challenges.
 - Add a competitive element: which defense can stop the runner at 2nd base or earlier on average?
 - Ask: 'Kicker — where did you aim your kick? Did it work?'

Phrases to Use

- "Kicker — aim your kick to an open area. Make the defense run!"
- "Defense — sprint to your spot! Every second counts."
- "Version 2: over, under, over, under — fast and clean!"
- "Runner — pump your arms, keep moving until you hear Stop!"
- "No outs here — every kick matters for your team's score."

Game: Cleaning the House

 **Reference Video:** *Cleaning the House* — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FTfWTmZfVsw>

Skill Focus

Throwing and rolling mechanics | Gross motor coordination | Kicking and punting fundamentals

1 — Setup

- Divide the playing area into 4 equal quadrants using cones or chalk lines.
- Assign one team to each quadrant.
- Scatter all balls evenly across all four quadrants at the start of each round.
- Place a trash can or designated collection area in each quadrant — this is where teams count their balls at the end.
- Set a round timer (2–3 minutes works well).

2 — How to Play

- On 'Go,' students pick up any ball in their quadrant and move it into another team's quadrant using the designated method for that round.
- The goal is to have as few balls as possible in your own territory when time is called.
- Students can send balls to any of the other three quadrants.
- When time is called, all students collect the balls in their quadrant and count them — the team with the fewest balls wins.
- Run multiple rounds using different throwing/moving methods each time:
- Round 1: Underhand rolling.
- Round 2: Overhand throwing — emphasize stepping with the opposite foot.
- Round 3: Kicking with the foot.
- Round 4: Punting — hold the ball and kick it from the hands.
- Round 5: Throwing between the legs.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- In Round 2, is the student stepping with their opposite foot when throwing — or throwing arm-only?
- In Round 3, are students using the inside of the foot for direction, or toe-kicking randomly?
- In Round 4, is the punt controlled — making contact with the foot at a consistent drop point?

- Are students playing efficiently — picking up and throwing quickly — or pausing between each action?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use only Rounds 1 and 3 (rolling and kicking) — the motor demands are most accessible.
 - Use lighter, larger balls that are easier to grip, roll, and kick.
 - Reduce the number of balls per quadrant so the activity feels less chaotic.
 - Allow students to carry the ball across the line if throwing is too difficult.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Run Rounds 1–3. Add Round 4 (punting) only if there is time.
 - Demonstrate the opposite-foot step in Round 2 before the round starts.
 - Keep rounds short (2 minutes) to maintain high energy.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Run all 5 rounds.
 - Hold students to proper mechanics for each round — correct a toe kick or an arm-only throw in real time.
 - Add a challenge: students must throw or kick from behind a line rather than walking to the boundary.

Phrases to Use

- "Opposite foot forward when you throw — step toward your target!"
- "Roll it low — keep it on the ground so it's harder to stop."
- "Kick with the inside of your foot for direction."
- "Punt: hold it, drop it, kick it — don't throw it up, just let it drop."
- "Work fast — every second you're not moving a ball, the other team is!"

Game: Ultimate Ball

 **Reference Video:** Ultimate Ball — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Px9uWkFV9iU>

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy and catching | Movement off the ball | 1v1 defense | Teamwork and strategic positioning

1 — Setup

- Form two equal teams — use pinnies or colored vests to differentiate.
- Mark end zones on each side of the playing area using 4 cones (2 per end zone).
- Use a handball, playground ball, or any available ball.
- No goalkeepers — all players are active on the field.
- Start with the ball at the center of the field.

2 — How to Play

- The ball can only be moved by passing — no running with the ball at any time.
- The player holding the ball must stay stationary — they may pivot but not take steps.
- A point is scored when a player catches the ball inside the opposing team's end zone.
- If a pass is incomplete (dropped, intercepted, or out of bounds), possession switches to the other team.
- No physical contact is allowed at any time.
- After a point is scored, the team that was scored on restarts from their own end zone.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players without the ball making active runs to get open — or standing and waiting?
- Is the player with the ball scanning quickly and making decisions before defenders close down?
- Are defenders marking specific players — or all chasing the ball?
- Are teams spreading across the whole field, or bunching near the ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use teams of 3–4 so each player has more space and more touches.
 - Use cone targets instead of end zones: teams earn a point by knocking over a cone.
 - Walk through the 'no running with the ball' rule physically before starting — have students practice passing and freezing.
 - Coach can stand near the action to prompt movement: 'Run to an open space!'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use teams of 5–6.
 - Pause play once or twice to point out open space: 'Look — your teammate is open on the right!'
 - Reinforce the pivot rule: 'You can turn, but your feet can't move.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a rule: teams must complete 3 passes before scoring.
 - Introduce basic defensive concepts: 'One person marks the ball carrier, others mark their players.'
 - After the game, debrief: 'What made it hard to score? What helped your team get open?'

Phrases to Use

- "Move to open space! If you're standing still, you're impossible to pass to."
- "No running with the ball — catch it, plant, and look to pass."
- "Defense — mark a person, not the ball. Know who you're guarding."
- "Spread out! If you all cluster, you block your own passing lanes."
- "Good pivot! You turned to find the open player without moving your feet."

Game: Four-Way Capture the Flag

 **Reference Video:** 4-Way Capture the Flag <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Px9uWkFV9iU>

Skill Focus

Strategic thinking and decision-making | Teamwork and communication
| Agility and speed | Spatial awareness

1 — Setup

- Divide the playing area into 4 equal territories — one per team (yellow, green, red, blue).
- Mark each team's castle/territory clearly using cones or hula hoops.
- Each team holds 2 beanbags (or small objects) from each of the other three teams — 6 items total per team — distributed at the start.
- Each team's own colored items are spread across the other three castles.
- Each student wears or holds a flag (flag football belt, ribbon, or pinnie) that must be returned to their castle after each retrieval.

2 — How to Play

- The goal is to retrieve both of your team's beanbags from each of the other three castles — 6 items total — and bring them back to your own territory.
- Students cross into another team's territory by stepping over the boundary cones.
- Once inside another team's castle, students have a 5-second safe zone to grab one beanbag before returning.
- After returning a beanbag, students must go back to their own castle and re-tag their home base before going out again.
- No flag guarding, spinning, or jumping to avoid being tagged.
- The first team to retrieve all 6 of their colored items wins.
- Blacktop variation: students may only speed walk — running results in returning to their home castle.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students planning their routes — deciding which castle to target — or running around randomly?
- Is the team communicating — designating some players as defenders while others retrieve?
- Are students returning to re-tag their home base after each retrieval, or forgetting?

- Are students being strategic about the 5-second safe zone — acting quickly once inside a castle?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Simplify to a 2-team version: one territory each, retrieve all items from the opponent's side.
 - Remove the flag and re-tagging requirement — just focus on retrieval.
 - Allow students to take 2 items at a time so rounds move faster.
 - Coach can guide students toward the correct castle to reduce confusion.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use the full 4-team setup.
 - Walk through the rules with a brief demonstration before starting — especially the re-tagging rule.
 - Encourage teams to huddle briefly: 'Who is defending? Who is retrieving? Which castle first?'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Full rules as described — hold students to the re-tag requirement strictly.
 - Add a strategic twist: teams can choose to steal items already retrieved by another team if they dare to enter that team's castle.
 - Debrief after: 'Did you have a plan? What worked? What would you change?'

Phrases to Use

- "Have a plan before you run — which castle are you going to?"
- "Team — decide who defends and who retrieves. You can't all attack at once."
- "5 seconds inside — grab it and go!"
- "Re-tag your home base before you go back out — don't forget!"
- "Communicate! Tell your team what you're doing."

Game: Animal Rescue Run (TK–2nd)

Skill Focus

Locomotor skills — running, hopping, skipping | Turn-taking and patience
| Spatial awareness | Basic teamwork

1 — Setup

- Scatter cones or soft objects ('animals') across the field — spread them out so students have to travel to collect them.
- Create a clearly marked 'Rescue Zone' (home base) for each team using cones.
- Divide students into 2–3 teams of equal size.
- Each team lines up behind their starting cone, facing the scattered animals.

2 — How to Play

- On 'Go,' the first player from each team runs out to the field, picks up one animal, and carries it back to their team's Rescue Zone.
- After returning the animal, they tag the next player in line — that player then goes.
- Only 1 animal may be carried at a time.
- Players continue taking turns until all animals have been collected.
- The team with the most animals in their Rescue Zone at the end wins.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students waiting for the tag before running — or going before it's their turn?
- Is movement controlled — students running without crashing into each other or other teams?
- Are students picking up animals efficiently, or getting distracted mid-run?
- Are students cheering for their teammates while they wait in line?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK:**
 - Allow walking instead of running — reduce the pace to keep it safe and manageable.

- Reduce the distance to the animals so the course is short.
- Play cooperatively instead of competitively — one big Rescue Zone, all teams collect together.
- Use very large, easy-to-grab soft objects so picking them up isn't a challenge.
- **1st–2nd:**
 - Add simple obstacles on the course: zig-zag through cones, jump over a line, or bear crawl for one section.
 - Require a specific locomotor movement each round: 'This round — skip to the animals!'
 - Add a light competitive element: track team scores across multiple rounds.

Phrases to Use

- "Wait for the tag — don't go until your teammate touches your hand!"
- "One animal only — drop it in the zone before you go again."
- "Cheer for your team while you wait! Let's hear it!"
- "Watch out for other teams — keep your eyes up when you run."
- "Skip to the animal — big skips!"

Game: Sharks and Minnows (TK–2nd)

Skill Focus

Agility and change of direction | Spatial awareness | Reaction time
| Decision-making — when to run, when to stop

1 — Setup

- Mark two end lines on opposite sides of the field to create start and end zones.
- Place 2–4 cones in the middle of the field as 'Safe Islands.'
- Select 1–3 students as 'Sharks' — they start in the middle of the field.
- All other students ('Minnows') start on one end line.

2 — How to Play

- Minnows try to run from one end line to the other without being tagged by a shark.
- Sharks stay in the middle section of the field and try to tag minnows as they cross.
- If a minnow is tagged, they perform a quick task (5 jumping jacks or 3 hops) and then rejoin the next crossing attempt.
- Minnows can stop at a Safe Island cone for a brief rest — maximum 3–5 seconds — before continuing.
- After each round, rotate the sharks so different students get a turn.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are minnows changing direction to avoid sharks — or just running straight and hoping for the best?
- Are students using the Safe Islands strategically — pausing at the right moment — or ignoring them?
- Are sharks spreading out to cover the field, or clustering in one spot?
- Are tagged students completing their quick task and rejoining quickly — or standing around?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK:**
 - Use only 1 shark so pressure is minimal.
 - Make Safe Islands larger (use hula hoops) so students can easily reach safety.
 - Allow walking instead of running — focus on spatial awareness over speed.
 - Coach can play alongside the students to guide movement and keep it fun.
- **1st–2nd:**
 - Use 2 sharks for a group of 12+.
 - Limit time on Safe Islands to 3 seconds — count aloud together.
 - Add a movement constraint: 'This round, minnows must skip across — no running!'
 - After a few rounds, ask: 'What did you do to avoid getting tagged?'

Phrases to Use

- "Change direction! Don't just run straight — make the shark guess."
- "Safe Island — 3 seconds max. Count it out: 1, 2, 3 — go!"
- "Sharks — spread out. Cover the whole middle, not just one side."
- "You got tagged? Jumping jacks, then get back in!"
- "Watch the shark's feet — which way are they moving?"

Game: Zone Pass Challenge

Skill Focus

Passing accuracy and control | Teamwork and communication |
Strategic thinking | Spatial awareness and positioning

1 — Setup

- Divide the field into 3–5 large zones using cone lines — zones should be wide enough for 2–3 players to move within them.
- Split students into 2 equal teams using pinnies.
- Give each team 1 ball — soccer ball, football, or playground ball.
- Teams spread out across the zones before play begins — no more than 2–3 players per zone.

2 — How to Play

- Teams score a point by successfully passing the ball through each zone in order — Zone 1 to Zone 2 to Zone 3, etc. — without losing possession.
- Players must stay within their assigned zone — no running across zone lines.
- The ball must move from one zone to the next via a pass — no carrying.
- If the ball is dropped or intercepted, possession immediately switches to the other team.
- After completing a full sequence across all zones, the team earns 1 point and starts again from Zone 1.
- The team with the most completed sequences when time is called wins.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players in each zone getting open and creating passing angles — or standing behind defenders?
- Are passes sharp and on target — or floating and easily intercepted?
- Are teams communicating across zones — or each zone acting independently?
- When possession is lost, are teams transitioning quickly to defense — or standing around?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow players to move freely between zones — remove the zone restriction.
 - Use rolling or short underhand passes only.
 - Remove the interception rule — focus only on completing passes as a team.
 - Use 3 zones maximum and keep them wide so passing distances are short.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the zone rule — players stay in their zone.
 - Add 1 defender per zone who tries to intercept.
 - Prompt communication: 'Shout I'm open! so your teammate knows where to pass.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add defenders in all zones.
 - Limit steps: players may only take 3 steps before passing.
 - Require specific pass types each round: bounce pass only, then chest pass only.
 - Introduce a time element: 5 seconds maximum to pass once you receive the ball.

Phrases to Use

- "Get open! Move to a space where your teammate can see you."
- "Sharp passes — soft passes get intercepted."
- "Communicate across zones — let your teammates know you're ready!"
- "Stay in your zone. Trust your teammates to handle their zone."
- "Quick transition — if you lose the ball, get into defense immediately!"



Blacktop Games

Blacktop Games

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Game: Floorball

 **Reference Video:** Floorball — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VRvXggLNV0A>

Skill Focus

Striking mechanics — paddle, stick, or hands | Passing and teamwork |
Offensive and defensive positioning | Hand-eye coordination

1 — Setup

- Blacktop: Use an existing Four Square court, or draw a similar 2x2 grid with chalk. Each square represents one player's zone.
- Indoor: Create a 2v2 grid using cones and floor tape — roughly the same size as a Four Square court.
- Teams of 2 compete against another team of 2. Each team defends their back boundary line as a goal.
- Equipment: Use foam balls, gator skin balls, or floor hockey balls. Optionally use short paddles or sticks — hands work fine for younger grades.
- For larger groups, run multiple courts simultaneously and rotate teams between courts.

2 — How to Play

- Teams attempt to strike the ball past the opposing team's back boundary line to score a point.
- Players must stay within their own designated square or zone when striking.
- Players may strike the ball directly toward the goal or pass to their teammate first.
- The ball must stay low and controlled at all times — no high or airborne hits.
- If the ball goes out of bounds, restart from the center.
- After a goal is scored, the team that was scored on rotates out and a new team rotates in — King of the Court style.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students keeping strikes low and controlled — or swinging hard and sending the ball high?
- Are players staying within their designated zone, or drifting into their teammate's space?
- Is the team using passing before shooting, or always going directly for the goal?
- On defense, are players positioning themselves to cut off angles — or just reacting after the ball is struck?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow players to stop the ball before striking — no immediate striking off a rolling ball.
 - Use hands instead of paddles or sticks — roll or push the ball rather than strike it.
 - Remove zone restrictions — allow free movement within the full grid.
 - Slow the pace: no striking the ball immediately after a pass.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce staying within zones — players should not cross into their teammate's square.
 - Require at least 1 pass between teammates before attempting to score.
 - Blacktop note: the ball moves faster on pavement — emphasize control over power.
 - Use softer balls on the blacktop to keep the game safe.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a one-touch rule for advanced groups: receive and strike in one motion.
 - Introduce light defensive pressure — players may reach to block but no body contact.
 - Rotate teams quickly so wait times stay short.
 - Pause play if striking becomes too aggressive — reset and reinforce controlled swings.

Phrases to Use

- "Low and controlled — this isn't hockey, no big swings!"
- "Stay in your zone. Let your teammate handle their side."
- "Pass first, then shoot. Work as a team."
- "Defense — cut off the angle. Get between the ball and your goal line."
- "On the blacktop, the ball is fast — use less power, more direction."

Game: Two Square (TK–2nd)

 **Reference Video:** Two Square — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oM4F44BU-gM>

Skill Focus

Hand-eye coordination | Underhand striking mechanics | Net game concepts | Skill progression and development

1 — Setup

- Use an existing Two Square court on the blacktop. The white center line acts as the net.
- One student stands in each square.
- Additional students form a line beside the court, waiting to rotate in.
- Use a playground ball or handball that bounces consistently on pavement.

2 — How to Play

- The ball must be struck over the white center line and bounce once inside the opponent's square.
- If a player fails to return the ball correctly — it goes out of bounds, doesn't bounce in the square, or they miss — they rotate out and the next player in line steps in.
- Play moves through three progressive skill levels:
- Progression 1 (easiest): Toss the ball up, let it bounce once, then catch it — no striking yet.
- Progression 2: Drop the ball, strike it after the bounce, let it bounce in opponent's square, opponent catches.
- Progression 3 (hardest): Drop, strike, bounce in opponent's square, opponent strikes it back — continuous rally.
- Students begin at Progression 1 and advance when they demonstrate consistent control.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student making contact with a flat, open hand — or hitting with a fist or closed hand?
- Is the ball landing in the opponent's square, or consistently going wide or long?
- In Progression 3, is the student getting into position early — or always reacting late?
- Is the student using a controlled underhand swing, or swatting at the ball?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK:**
 - Stay at Progression 1 or 2 — the full rally in Progression 3 is too complex.
 - Use a larger, softer ball that is easier to track and control.
 - Allow the ball to bounce twice before returning — reduces time pressure.
 - Coach can demonstrate each progression slowly before students attempt.
- **1st–2nd:**
 - Progress through all three levels within the same session — start at 1 and advance when ready.
 - Require students to call 'ready' before the ball is served so both players are prepared.
 - Once Progression 3 is comfortable, introduce a gentle challenge: how many rallies in a row?

Phrases to Use

- "Flat hand — like you're giving the ball a high five."
- "Watch the ball all the way onto your hand."
- "Aim inside the square — not just over the line."
- "Get in position early. Move your feet before the ball gets to you."
- "Nice rally! How many can you get in a row?"

Game: Foursquare (3rd–6th)

 **Reference Video:** Foursquare — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6-tfrnWr3xw>

Skill Focus

Underhand striking and volleying | Ball control and court awareness |
Reaction time and hand-eye coordination | Net game concepts

1 — Setup

- Use an existing Foursquare court with squares labeled A, B, C, and D.
- One student stands in each square. Remaining students form a single line beside the court and rotate into Square D.
- The student in Square A is the server and starts each round.
- Use a playground ball that bounces consistently on pavement.

2 — How to Play

- The server lets the ball bounce once in their own square, then underhand strikes it into Square C to begin play.
- The first serve of each round is a gentle, no-elimination serve — no one can be called out on the opening serve.
- After the opening serve, players volley the ball back and forth across squares.
- A player is out if: the ball hits a line off their hit, the ball goes outside of their square off their hit, or they hit the ball into the air and another player catches it.
- When a player is out, they go to the back of the waiting line and the next player rotates into Square D.
- Players advance toward Square A as others rotate out — Square A is the server position.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players using an underhand strike — open palm moving upward — or slapping down at the ball?
- Is the student getting under the ball early and positioning their feet, or reaching and off-balance?
- Are students aware of the line rules — or frequently disputing calls?
- Is the server starting rounds with a fair, gentle serve, or trying to immediately eliminate opponents?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **3rd–4th:**
 - Walk through the three elimination rules clearly before the first round — lines, out of square, and the catch rule.
 - Reinforce the gentle opening serve: 'First serve is friendly — no sneaky shots!'
 - Rotate players in quickly so wait times stay short.
 - If disputes arise, use a simple replay rule: any disputed call = redo the point.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Hold students to the line and boundary rules strictly — self-officiation is part of the game.
 - Allow students to introduce optional house rules (e.g., 'bus stop,' 'around the world') once the base game is running smoothly.
 - Track how long the current Square A player can hold their position — creates a fun individual challenge within the group game.

Phrases to Use

- "Underhand only — open palm, swing up."
- "Get your feet to the ball. Don't just reach with your arm."
- "Lines are out. Call it honestly."
- "First serve is gentle — no power serves to start the round."
- "Catch rule: if someone hits it up and you catch it, the hitter is out!"

Game: Handball Progressions (TK–2nd)

 **Reference Video:** *Handball Progressions* — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6-tfrnWr3xw>

Skill Focus

Throwing and striking mechanics | Hand-eye coordination | Wall ball fundamentals | Skill progression and mastery

1 — Setup

- Find a clear wall section on the blacktop — enough space for students to stand 4–6 feet from the wall.
- Students form lines perpendicular to the wall — one student per line works at the wall at a time.
- Use a handball, tennis ball, or similar small ball.
- Mark a line on the ground (or use an existing court line) to indicate where students should stand.

2 — How to Play

- Students stand sideways to the wall and use a chopping/striking motion to send the ball at the ground first, then the wall.
- The ball must bounce on the ground once before hitting the wall — this is the core rule across all progressions.
- Each student must complete a progression 5 times successfully before passing the ball to the next person and going to the back of the line.
- Work through progressions in order — students only advance when they are consistent:
- Progression 1: Throw → bounce → wall → bounce → catch.
- Progression 2: Throw → bounce → wall → catch (no second bounce).
- Progression 3: Strike → bounce → wall → bounce → catch.
- Progression 4: Strike → bounce → wall → catch.
- Progression 5: Continuous volley off the wall — keep it going as long as possible.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student standing sideways — or facing the wall straight-on (incorrect stance)?
- Is the ball hitting the ground first before the wall — or going directly at the wall?
- In Progressions 3–4, is the student using a true strike (chopping motion) — or reverting to a throw?

- In Progression 5, is the student recovering their position after each hit — or getting caught flat-footed?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK:**
 - Focus only on Progressions 1 and 2 — throwing mechanics before striking.
 - Use a larger, bouncier ball (playground ball) so the bounce-wall sequence is easier to achieve.
 - Allow students to face the wall forward if the sideways stance is too confusing to start.
 - Coach demonstrates each step slowly before students try.
- **1st–2nd:**
 - Move through all 5 progressions — most 1st and 2nd graders can reach Progression 4 within a session.
 - Enforce the sideways stance — prompt it before each attempt: 'Shoulder to the wall!'
 - Count the 5 successful attempts together as a group so students know when they advance.
 - Progression 5 challenge: how many continuous volleys can a student complete? Track their best.

Phrases to Use

- "Shoulder to the wall — turn sideways before you throw."
- "Ground first, THEN wall. Bounce it down, not at the wall."
- "Chop motion — like you're chopping wood with your hand."
- "5 in a row — count them out loud. 1... 2... 3..."
- "Progression 5: keep it going! How many can you get?"

Game: Handball (1st–6th)

 **Reccomended Prereq:** Complete [Handball Progressions](#) before introducing this game.

 **Reference Video:** Handball — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=863ns3sBAzE>

Skill Focus

Handball striking mechanics | Hand-eye coordination and reaction time
| Competitive play and strategy | Anticipation and positioning

1 — Setup

- Played against a wall on the blacktop — use an existing court line as the front boundary if available.
- Students form a single line beside the playing area and rotate in based on the version being played.
- Use a handball or tennis ball.
- Prerequisite: students should have completed Handball Progressions before playing this game.

2 — How to Play

- Core rule across all versions: the ball must bounce once on the ground before hitting the wall.
- After coming off the wall, the active player may let it bounce once before striking — or hit it out of the air.
- The ball can never bounce twice — if it does, the active player is out.
- If a player makes a mistake, they go to the back of the line and the next player steps in.
- Version 1 — 1v1: Two students play against each other. The player who makes a mistake goes to the back of the line.
- Version 2 — 2v2: Two students play against two others. If either player in a pair makes a mistake, the whole pair goes to the back of the line.
- Version 3 — Elimination: All students line up. Each player hits the ball off the wall and goes to the back of the line. A mistake = elimination. When 2 players remain, they must touch the white line before each return hit. Last player standing wins.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student striking with control — directing the ball at the wall — or just swinging and hoping?

- Is the student recovering quickly after their hit and getting back into a ready position?
- In Version 2, are partners communicating — calling who takes the ball?
- In Version 3, are students tracking the ball all the way through the sequence — or losing focus when it's not their turn?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **1st–2nd:**
 - Start with Version 1 only — 1v1 is the simplest to understand and manage.
 - Allow 2 bounces (instead of 1) after the wall to give students more time to react.
 - Keep rotation fast — short rallies are fine at this age.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce Version 2 (2v2) once 1v1 is running smoothly.
 - In Version 2, coach partners to communicate: 'Call yours or mine before you hit!'
 - Hold students to the 1-bounce rule — enforce it consistently.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Run Version 3 (Elimination) — students at this age love the competitive format.
 - Enforce the white-line rule strictly in the final 2-player showdown.
 - Add a tournament bracket format across multiple wall sections if space allows.
 - Ask: 'Where are you aiming on the wall? What angle makes the return harder for your opponent?'

Phrases to Use

- "Ground first, then wall — same rule as progressions."
- "One bounce max after the wall. Two bounces and you're out."
- "2v2: call it! 'Mine!' or 'Yours!' before you swing."
- "Ready position — hands up, weight forward, eyes on the ball."
- "Aim your hit. Where on the wall makes it hardest for them to return?"

Game: Two Touch

 **Reference Video:** Two Touch — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X5RyTePxIWl>

Skill Focus

Two-touch soccer skills | Kicking mechanics and foot control | Wall ball strategy | Body control and coordination

1 — Setup

- Played against a wall on the blacktop — use a section of wall with enough flat space for students to kick and receive.
- Use a soccer ball.
- Students form a single line beside the playing area and rotate in when a player is out.
- Mark a standing line on the ground (or use an existing court line) so students know where to play from.

2 — How to Play

- Each active player gets exactly two touches on the ball per turn.
- Touch 1: The player may kick the ball in the air or bounce it on the ground.
- Touch 2: Must make contact with the wall — this is required, no exceptions.
- After the ball comes off the wall, the next player in line takes their two touches.
- If the ball hits a side wall before hitting the front wall, the active player is out.
- If a player fails to make wall contact on their second touch, they are out.
- A player may use their body (chest, thigh) to control the ball and bring it down — but the second touch must still hit the wall.
- When a player is out, they go to the back of the line and the next player steps in.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the student planning both touches — or improvising and losing control on Touch 2?
- Is Touch 1 setting up a clean Touch 2, or making the wall hit difficult?
- Are students using different surfaces of the foot (inside, instep, outside) — or always the same?
- When using the body to control, is the student staying balanced — or off-balance after the control touch?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Simplify to one touch only: kick the ball directly at the wall in one move.
 - Use a larger, softer ball so wall contact is easier to achieve.
 - Allow the ball to bounce before hitting the wall on Touch 2.
 - Focus on getting any contact on the wall — accuracy and technique come later.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce the two-touch rule and walk through it slowly: 'Touch 1 is yours to choose, Touch 2 must hit the wall.'
 - Allow the body control option once students are comfortable with foot-only touches.
 - Rotate players in quickly — short turns keep energy high.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Enforce both touches strictly — any rule violation is an out.
 - Add a challenge: Touch 1 must be with the non-dominant foot.
 - Ask students: 'What did you do with Touch 1 to make Touch 2 easier?'
 - Run an elimination format (same as Handball Version 3) for a competitive end-of-session game.

Phrases to Use

- "Two touches — Touch 1 sets it up, Touch 2 hits the wall."
- "Plan ahead. Where is Touch 1 going to put the ball for Touch 2?"
- "Side wall = out. Keep it on the front wall."
- "Body touch is fine — just make sure Touch 2 still hits the wall."
- "What part of your foot are you using? Try a different surface."

Game: Treasure Protectors

Skill Focus

Spatial awareness | Offensive vs. defensive decision-making |
Strategic thinking | Agility and team collaboration

1 — Setup

- Use cones to create 3–4 circular Treasure Zones across the blacktop — each zone should be large enough for 2–3 players to stand inside.
- Place 5–10 objects (balls, beanbags, or cones) inside each zone — these are the 'treasure.'
- Divide students into 3–4 equal teams, one team per zone.
- Each team starts inside their own zone.
- Define a clear outer boundary for the full play area.

2 — How to Play

- Each team protects their own treasure while trying to steal objects from other teams' zones.
- Players may leave their zone at any time to raid another team's treasure.
- Only 1 object may be carried at a time — players must return it to their own zone before going again.
- If a player is tagged while outside their own zone, they must return the stolen object to the zone they took it from and go back to their home zone before continuing.
- Players are safe from being tagged when inside their own zone.
- Play rounds of 3–5 minutes. At the end of each round, teams count the objects in their zone — the team with the most wins.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are players making smart decisions — balancing offense (raiding) and defense (protecting) — or all doing one or the other?
- Is the team communicating — designating some players as defenders while others raid?
- Are students being strategic about which zone to target — or always going to the same one?
- Are tags safe and controlled — light tag only, no grabbing or pushing?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Remove tagging entirely — focus only on collecting objects.
 - Allow players to carry 2 objects at a time so younger students feel more success.
 - Shrink the play area so zones are closer together.
 - Use only 2 teams to simplify the concept before scaling up.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Introduce tagging — but reinforce light tag only before every round.
 - Encourage teams to assign roles: 'Who is staying to guard? Who is raiding?'
 - Keep a whistle or clear stop signal so rounds end crisply.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a 'jail' rule: when tagged, players go to a designated jail spot and must wait for a teammate to free them with a high five.
 - Limit the number of players who can leave the zone at once — forces strategic decisions.
 - After rounds, debrief: 'What was your team's strategy? Did you guard or attack more? What would you change?'

Phrases to Use

- "Balance your team — not everyone raids, not everyone defends."
- "Light tag only — fingertip touch, no grabbing."
- "One object at a time. Get it home before you go again."
- "If you get tagged, return the object first, then come back."
- "Team huddle before the round — who guards, who raids?"

Game: Clean Your Yard

Skill Focus

Throwing and rolling mechanics | Reaction time and movement efficiency | Hand-eye coordination | Quick decision-making under pressure

1 — Setup

- Divide the blacktop into two equal halves using cones or an existing center line.
- Scatter 20–40 soft objects (balls, beanbags, soft cones) evenly across both sides at the start.
- Split students into 2 equal teams — one team per side.
- Ensure all objects are safe for throwing and rolling on pavement.
- Set a round timer — 2–4 minutes works well. Shorter rounds keep energy high.

2 — How to Play

- The goal is to have the fewest objects on your side of the line when time is called.
- On 'Go,' players pick up objects and throw or roll them to the other team's side — using whatever method is designated for that round.
- Players may only throw from their own side — no crossing the center line.
- Both teams work simultaneously, continuously sending objects back and forth for the full duration of the round.
- When time is called, both sides count their objects — the team with the fewer objects wins.
- Run multiple rounds using different throwing methods to build different motor skills.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students picking up and throwing quickly — or pausing between each action?
- Is the throwing form correct for the designated round (e.g., opposite foot forward in overhand rounds)?
- Are students spreading out across their side — or all clustering near the center line?
- Are students throwing safely — at an appropriate height and force — or launching objects dangerously?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow walking objects to the line and placing them over instead of throwing.
 - Use fewer objects (10–15) so the activity feels less chaotic.
 - Keep rounds to 90 seconds — shorter attention spans.
 - Use only underhand rolling — the safest and most accessible method.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Run Rounds 1–3: underhand roll, overhand throw, and kick.
 - Demonstrate the opposite-foot step before Round 2 — reinforce it throughout.
 - Reinforce throwing below waist height only on the blacktop — safety first.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Run all 5 round variations: underhand roll, overhand throw, kick, punt, between the legs.
 - Add a rule: non-dominant hand only for one round.
 - Limit players to holding 1 object at a time — keeps movement fast and spread out.
 - Add a 3-team triangle version if space allows — adds extra chaos and fun.

Phrases to Use

- "Pick it up and go — don't stop to think, just throw!"
- "Opposite foot forward when you throw — step toward your target."
- "Spread out! If you all crowd the middle, you're tripping over each other."
- "Keep throws below the waist — this is not a dodgeball game."
- "Round 2: overhand only. Show me that opposite foot step!"



Indoor Games

Indoor Games

ELP Summer 2026 — Sports Curriculum

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Game: Cone Flip Relay

 **Reference Video:** Cone Flip Relay — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VRvXggLNV0A>

Skill Focus

Gross motor skills and coordination | Relay race fundamentals |
Teamwork and communication | Persistence and problem-solving

1 — Setup

- Set up 4–6 rows in the indoor playing area — one row per team.
- Aim for a roughly equal number of students per row.
- At the far end of each row, lay cones flat on the ground in a line — one cone per 'level.' Space them out so each flip attempt has a clear target.
- Students line up behind their row's starting cone, ready to run.

2 — How to Play

- On 'Go!' the first player sprints to the far end of their row and attempts to flip the first cone upright — in one try.
- Whether they make it or miss, the player runs back and high-fives the next person in line.
- The next player goes and attempts to flip the next cone in the row.
- Once all cones in a level are successfully flipped upright, the team advances to the next level.
- The first team to complete all levels sits down and raises their hand to signal they are finished.
- Groups that finish early reset their cones and start again — no standing around waiting.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students waiting for the high five before running — or going early?
- Is the cone flip attempt deliberate — are students pausing and aiming — or rushing and flailing?
- Are students encouraging their teammates while waiting in line, or disengaged?
- Are teams handling missed flips with resilience — or getting frustrated and giving up?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use larger, lighter cones that are easier to flip upright.
 - Allow 2 attempts per cone before moving on — reduces frustration.
 - Shorten the running distance so TK students can complete the relay without tiring.
 - Coach can narrate the action to keep younger students focused: 'Run! Flip! Come back!'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Standard rules — one flip attempt per cone.
 - Add a second set of levels after all teams finish the first for extended play.
 - Encourage teams to cheer for each runner — build team culture.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add additional levels to keep the challenge going for faster groups.
 - Introduce a penalty flip: if a student knocks a previously flipped cone over while flipping the next one, they must re-flip it before running back.
 - Time the relay: can the team beat their previous best?

Phrases to Use

- "Wait for the high five — don't go until you feel the tag!"
- "Take a breath before you flip — aim, don't rush."
- "Cheer for your team while you wait. Let's hear it!"
- "You missed? That's okay — shake it off, the next person goes."
- "Can your team beat last round's time? Let's find out!"

Game: Head, Shoulders, Knees, Cone!

 **Reference Video:** Head, Shoulders, Knees, Cone! - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W5vEy0RHwRM>

Skill Focus

Listening and reaction time | Body awareness and coordination |
Focus and competitive engagement

1 — Setup

- Pair students up and have partners face each other.
- Place one cone flat on the ground between each pair.
- Both students start in a squat position with hands on their knees.
- The caller (teacher or designated student) stands where all pairs can see and hear them clearly.

2 — How to Play

- The caller calls out body parts in any order — head, shoulders, knees, or toes.
- Both students in each pair touch the corresponding body part each time it is called.
- When the caller yells 'Cone!' — the first student in each pair to grab the cone wins that round.
- The caller can mix up the sequence, speed up, slow down, or fake — whatever keeps students alert.
- Partners reset after each round (cone back on the ground, squat position) and play again.
- Play as many rounds as time allows — pairs can track their own wins if desired.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students staying in the squat position and touching body parts with both hands — or cheating their way to an early grab?
- Are students reacting on 'Cone!' — or hesitating because they are not focused?
- Is the caller varying the pace and sequence enough to keep both partners guessing?
- Are students handling wins and losses with good sportsmanship — or reacting negatively when they lose a round?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Start by giving every student their own cone — each student practices touching body parts and grabbing their cone individually, no competition yet.
 - Once students understand the body part sequence, introduce the competitive version with pairs.
 - Use only 2–3 body parts to start (just head and knees) before adding shoulders and toes.
 - Caller should move slowly at first — speed up only when students are comfortable.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Use all four body parts from the start.
 - Introduce fakes: call 'shoooulders...' slowly, pause, then call something else.
 - Encourage students to stay low — going to standing early telegraphs the grab.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Move fast and use fakes aggressively — the caller should try to trick students.
 - Add a bracket tournament: winners from each pair play winners of other pairs.
 - Let students take turns being the caller — they often love trying to trick their classmates.

Phrases to Use

- "Squat position — hands on knees until I say Cone!"
- "Stay focused — I'm going to try to fake you out."
- "Good grab! Now reset — cone down, squat position, ready."
- "Win or lose, shake hands with your partner after each round."
- "Caller — try to trick them! Speed up, slow down, fake it!"

Game: Rubber Band Cup Stack (3rd–6th)

 **Reference Video:** Rubber Band Cup Stack —
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W5vEy0RHwRM>

Skill Focus

Teamwork and communication | Problem-solving and strategy | Fine motor coordination | Collaborative decision-making

1 — Setup

- Form teams of 3–5 students.
- Each team gets one rubber band with one string tied to it per player — so a team of 4 has a rubber band with 4 strings.
- Place 6 cups (stacked or scattered) on a flat surface in front of each team.
- The goal is to stack the cups into a pyramid (3-2-1 formation) using only the rubber band and strings.

2 — How to Play

- Each player holds the end of one string attached to the shared rubber band — no one may touch the cups directly with their hands at any time.
- Players work together by pulling their strings outward to expand the rubber band wide enough to wrap around a cup, lift it, and place it in position.
- The team communicates to coordinate movements — who pulls, who guides, when to release.
- The first team to successfully stack all 6 cups into a complete pyramid wins the round.
- After completing the pyramid, teams can reset and try to beat their previous time.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Is the team communicating — giving clear verbal instructions — or all pulling in different directions silently?
- Are students adjusting their tension on the string based on what the cup needs — or all pulling at full strength?
- When the pyramid falls, does the team reset calmly and strategize — or fall apart?
- Is one student dominating the decisions, or is the team distributing leadership?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - This activity is designed for 3rd–6th. For younger students, try a simpler cooperative stacking challenge using hands.
 - If including TK–2nd, reduce to 3 cups and allow players to use one finger to guide (not fully grip) the cup.
 - Focus on the collaborative process — not speed or competition.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Walk through the mechanics before starting: practice expanding the rubber band around a cup without stacking first.
 - Assign one student per team as the 'director' for the first round — they call out instructions. Rotate the role each round.
 - Allow teams a 60-second planning session before each attempt.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Full competitive format: first team to complete the pyramid wins.
 - Add a time challenge: can the team beat their best time each round?
 - Remove the planning session — teams must communicate in real time.
 - Debrief after: 'What made it hard? What strategy worked best?'

Phrases to Use

- "Talk to each other — you can't do this silently."
- "Gentle tension — don't all pull as hard as you can. Feel the cup."
- "If it falls, that's okay. Reset, talk about what happened, try again."
- "Who's directing this round? Pick someone and listen to them."
- "Can you beat your last time? Give it another shot!"

Game: Crate Volleyball

 **Reference Video:** Crate Volleyball — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e2_XgNvwepA

Skill Focus

Underhand striking mechanics | Volleying and ball control |
Teamwork and communication | Hand-eye coordination

1 — Setup

- Form groups of 4–5 students.
- Each group circles around a crate placed flat on the ground in the center.
- Set up multiple crates of varying sizes around the indoor space — larger crates for beginners, smaller for advanced groups.
- Use a lightweight ball — foam ball or soft volleyball works well indoors.
- Groups rotate to a new crate every 3–4 minutes.

2 — How to Play

- Students use an underhand strike to hit the ball — no overhand hitting or spiking.
- Every player in the group must touch the ball at least once before anyone can attempt to hit it into the crate.
- Once all players have touched the ball, any player may attempt the final strike into the crate.
- After landing the ball in the crate (or after a set time), the group rotates to a new crate.
- Groups keep track of how many successful crate landings they achieve at each station.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students using a true underhand strike — open palm swinging upward — or pushing/slapping at the ball?
- Is the group completing the 'everyone touches' requirement before going for the crate — or rushing to shoot early?
- Are players communicating to set each other up — or each person just hitting toward the crate independently?
- Are students adjusting their striking power based on the size of the crate they are playing at?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use only the largest crates available.
 - Remove the 'everyone touches' requirement — allow students to hit toward the crate after just 1–2 passes.
 - Allow students to catch the ball and reset rather than volleying continuously.
 - Focus on the underhand motion — use a verbal cue: 'Swing up like you're scooping ice cream!'
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Enforce the 'everyone touches' rule — count passes aloud as a group.
 - Rotate groups to a smaller crate once they succeed at a larger one.
 - Prompt communication: 'Call for the ball — say 'Here!' before your teammate passes.'
- **5th–6th:**
 - Use smaller crates only.
 - Add a rule: the final strike into the crate must come from a specific player each round — designated before play starts.
 - Challenge: how many crate landings can a group achieve in 3 minutes?
 - Allow only one-touch volleys — no catching and resetting.

Phrases to Use

- "Underhand only — swing up, like you're scooping ice cream."
- "Has everyone touched it? Count together — 1, 2, 3, 4... now shoot!"
- "Set your teammate up — don't just smack it toward the crate."
- "Smaller crate = more precise strike. Less power, more aim."
- "Call for the ball before your teammate passes it!"

Game: Four Corners

 **Reference Video:** Four Corners — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9PVAPA9B_yU

Skill Focus

Listening and quick decision-making | Strategic thinking | Spatial awareness

1 — Setup

- Assign a number (1, 2, 3, or 4) to each corner of the indoor playing area — label them visibly with a cone or sign if possible.
- Select one student to stand in the middle with their eyes closed.
- All remaining students spread out around the room, not yet in a corner.

2 — How to Play

- The student in the middle closes their eyes and counts to ten — aloud so everyone can hear.
- While the count happens, all other students move to a corner of their choice and stand inside it.
- When the count reaches ten, the middle student calls out a number (1, 2, 3, or 4) without opening their eyes.
- All students standing in the called corner are eliminated and sit down.
- Play continues — the middle student counts again, remaining students move to a new corner.
- The last student still standing is the winner and becomes the next middle player.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students making deliberate strategic choices — avoiding corners that have been called recently or are crowded — or always going to the same corner?
- Are students moving safely during the count — no running or pushing to get to a corner?
- Is the middle student counting at a consistent pace — or rushing/slowing to give themselves an advantage?
- Are eliminated students sitting quietly and watching — or being disruptive from the sideline?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Use colors instead of numbers for corners (red, blue, green, yellow) — easier for younger students to identify.
 - Allow students to move freely and don't eliminate on the first round — one practice round where no one is out.
 - Keep eliminated students engaged by giving them a simple task: count how many students are left.
 - Coach can be the counter for early rounds to model the pace.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Standard rules with numbers.
 - Add a strategy prompt before the game: 'Think about which corner has the fewest people — that might be safer.'
 - Rotate the middle player every 3–4 rounds even if they haven't eliminated everyone, to keep the game moving.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Add a 'safe corner' twist: one corner is secretly designated safe each round — the middle player cannot call it. Reveal it after the call.
 - Let the middle player choose to call the number OR call 'all corners' — everyone is eliminated and the round restarts.
 - Students can play silently — no signals, no grouping together to coordinate.

Phrases to Use

- "Make a choice and commit — don't switch corners at the last second."
- "Look around — which corner has the most people? That might not be the safest bet."
- "Counter — keep a steady pace. No speeding up to trick people."
- "If you're eliminated, sit down quietly and cheer for everyone still in."
- "Last three standing — let's see who takes it!"

Game: Silent Ball

 **Reference Video:** Silent Ball — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UY2sYFh6lwM>

Skill Focus

Self-control and following directions | Throwing and catching fundamentals | Focus and sustained attention | Non-verbal communication and spatial awareness

1 — Setup

- Students stand silently beside or between their chairs — in a configuration where they can see and throw to anyone in the room.
- Choose a 'magic word' before the game begins — saying the magic word accidentally is an automatic elimination (adds a fun twist).
- Start with one ball. A second ball can be added later as a progression.
- The teacher designates who starts with the ball — typically the winner of the previous round.

2 — How to Play

- Absolute silence must be maintained at all times — no talking, no whispering, no sounds.
- Students pass the ball around the room using throws and catches.
- A student is eliminated and must sit down if they: drop the ball, talk or make any sound, or throw the ball too high, too low, or too hard (teacher's discretion).
- Eliminated students sit quietly in their seat and watch — no disrupting the game.
- The last student standing wins and starts the next round with the ball.
- Progression 1: Standard two-handed passing and catching.
- Progression 2: Students must catch with one hand only.
- Progression 3: A second ball is added — students must track two balls simultaneously.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students making eye contact with their target before throwing — using non-verbal communication?
- Are throws appropriate — catchable, not too hard, not too soft?
- Are students staying alert and tracking the ball even when it is not heading toward them?
- Are eliminated students sitting quietly — or trying to distract active players?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK–2nd:**
 - Allow very short distances between throwers to start — students can pass to neighbors only.
 - Use a larger, softer ball that is easier to grip and catch.
 - Allow one sound per student before elimination (a warning) — absolute silence can be frustrating for very young students.
 - Keep rounds short (2–3 minutes max) and restart frequently.
- **3rd–4th:**
 - Start with Progression 1 and advance to Progression 2 mid-round if things are going smoothly.
 - Enforce the silence rule consistently from the start — any sound is an out.
 - Let students choose who to throw to, but prompt them to include students who haven't touched the ball recently.
- **5th–6th:**
 - Start at Progression 2 (one-hand catch) and move to Progression 3 (two balls) quickly.
 - Add the magic word twist — choose a common word like 'the' and see how long before someone slips.
 - Challenge: can the class keep the ball in the air for 30 consecutive passes without an elimination?

Phrases to Use

- "Silence means silence. No sounds — not even a gasp."
- "Make eye contact before you throw. They need to know it's coming."
- "Throw to someone who hasn't had it in a while — keep everyone involved."
- "If you're out, sit quietly. Your job now is to watch and root for everyone still in."
- "Two balls! Stay alert — either one could come to you at any moment."

Game: Color Match Dash

Skill Focus

Listening and following directions | Spatial awareness | Reaction time
| Locomotor movement skills and decision-making

1 — Setup

- Scatter different colored cones or ploy spots around the indoor space — use at least 3–4 distinct colors.
- Make sure there are slightly fewer cones than students — this creates light competition without overcrowding.
- Clearly define the movement boundaries (classroom, MPR, gym floor, etc.).
- Have students spread out across the space before the first round begins.

2 — How to Play

- Students move safely around the space using a locomotor movement designated by the instructor (walk, skip, tiptoe, shuffle, etc.).
- When the instructor calls out a color, all students immediately find and stand next to a cone of that color.
- Students share cones if needed — no pushing or racing aggressively for a single spot.
- After each round, students return to moving around the space using the designated movement.
- The instructor calls a new color to start the next round.
- Optional: students who are the last to find a cone of the correct color perform a quick task (5 jumping jacks, 3 hops) before rejoining.

3 — Assessment (What Staff Should Look For)

- Are students reacting immediately when the color is called — or waiting to follow others?
- Are students using the full space while moving, or clustering near the same cones?
- Is the designated locomotor movement being used correctly — or are students reverting to running?
- Are students sharing cones cooperatively — or pushing and arguing over spots?

4 — Pro Tips & Suggestions

Grade-Band Modifications

- **TK:**
 - Use only 2–3 colors so color identification is simple.
 - Allow walking only — no other locomotor movements yet.
 - Give extra time after calling the color — count to 5 before checking who found it.
 - Celebrate finding the right color: 'You found green! Great job!'
- **1st–2nd:**
 - Introduce varied locomotor movements: skip one round, shuffle the next.
 - Call 2 colors at once and let students choose which one to go to — quick decision-making.
 - Add a 'no repeat' rule: students cannot go to the same cone two rounds in a row.
- **3rd–6th:**
 - Speed up the color calls to challenge reaction time.
 - Add a movement condition to each call: 'Blue — get there backwards!'
 - Introduce a points system: first 3 students to a cone earn a point — track across rounds.
 - Let a student be the caller for a round — they love the power.

Phrases to Use

- "Move the whole time — don't stand near one cone waiting for its color."
- "React fast! Go as soon as you hear the color — don't wait to see where others go."
- "Share the cone — there's room for two people."
- "Keep your eyes up and your feet moving."
- "Skipping only this round — I'm watching your feet!"